

Full contents of plants.bib and animals.bib

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Materia Medica Reference Works

- ADPS Sivarajan, V. V., and Balachandran, Indira (1994), *Ayurvedic Drugs and Their Plant Sources* (New Delhi, Bombay, Calcutta: Oxford & IBH Publishing).
- AVS Warriar, P. K., Nambiar, V. P. K., and Ramankutty, C. (1994–96) (eds.), *Indian Medicinal Plants: A Compendium of 500 Species. Vaidyaratnam P. S. Varier's Arya Vaidya Sala, Kottakal*, 5 vols. (Madras: Orient Longman).
- BIA Prater, S. H. (1993), *The Book of Indian Animals* (3rd edn., Bombay, Delhi, etc.: Oxford University Press), [ark:/13960/t6356w32f](https://nbn-resolving.org/urn:nbn:de:bsz:551-19960-t6356w32f); 4th impression of 3rd corrected 1980 edition.
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- Chopra Chopra, R. N., Nayar, S. L., and Chopra, I. C. (1956), *Glossary of Indian Medicinal Plants* (3rd reprint, 1992, New Delhi: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research); vol. 2: R. N. Chopra, I. C. Chopra, and Varma ([Chopra_{sup}](#)).
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URL: <https://tinyurl.com/dymock1890>, accessed 16/03/2023.
- GJM1 Meulenbeld, Gerrit Jan (1974a), "Sanskrit Names of Plants and their Botanical Equivalents," in id., *The Mādhavanidāna and Its Chief Commentary: Chapters 1–10. Introduction, Translation, and Notes* (Leiden: Brill), chap. Appendix Four, 520–611, [ark : / 13960 / t25b8q97g](https://nopr.scribd.com/archives/01/13960/t25b8q97g).
- GJM2 Meulenbeld, Gerrit Jan (1988), "G. J. Meulenbeld's Additions to his "Sanskrit Names of Plants and their Botanical Equivalents"," in Rahul Peter Das, *Das Wissen von der Lebensspanne der Bäume: Surapālas Vṛkṣāyurveda* (Stuttgart: Franz Steiner Verlag), chap. Appendix 1, 425–65, ISBN: 9783515046633; Supplement to GJM1.
- GVDB Singh, Thakur Balwant, and Chuneekar, K. C. (1972), *Glossary of Vegetable Drugs in Brhatrayi* (Varanasi: Chowkhamba Sanskrit Series Office), [ark : / 13960 / s2cvp72x58j](https://nopr.scribd.com/archives/01/13960/s2cvp72x58j).
- HK Hilgenberg, Luise, and Kirfel, Willibald (1941), *Vāgbhaṭa's Aṣṭāṅgaḥṛdayasaṃhitā, ein altindisches Lehrbuch der Heilkunde, aus dem Sanskrit ins Deutsche übertragen mit Einleitung, Anmerkungen und Indices* (Leiden: Brill), [ark : / 13960 / t52h05616](https://nopr.scribd.com/archives/01/13960/t52h05616).

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- K&B Kirtikar, K. R., Basu, B. D., and an I.C.S (1987), *Indian Medicinal Plants*, ed. E. Blatter, J. F. Caius, and K. S. Mhaskar, 8 vols. (2nd edn., Dehradun: International Book Distributors),
URL: <https://archive.org/details/biodiversity?tab=collection&query=kirtikar>;
First published in Allahabad, 1918.
- MBG Missouri Botanical Garden (2024), "Missouri Botanical Garden: Plant Finder," Missouri Botanical Garden,
URL: <https://bit.ly/MissouriPlantfinder>.
- NEH Bown, Deni (2001), *New Encyclopedia of Herbs and Their Uses* (2nd edn., London, New York etc: Dorling Kindersly).
- NK Nadkarni, K. M. (1982), *Dr. K. M. Nadkarni's Indian Materia Medica, with Ayurvedic, Unani-tibbi, Siddha, Allopathic, Homeopathic, Naturopathic & Home Remedies, Appendices & Indexes ... in Two Volumes*, ed. A. K. Nadkarni, 2 vols. (3 ed., revised and enlarged by A. K. Nadkarni, Bombay: Popular Prakashan), ISBN: 8171541429,
URL: <https://tinyurl.com/Nadkarni1982>; First published in 1954.

Peter	Peter, K. V. (2012) (ed.), <i>Handbook of Herbs and Spices</i> (Food Science, Technology and Nutrition, 228; 2nd edn., Oxford, Cambridge, Philadelphia, New Delhi: Woodhead Publishing), ISBN: 9780857090393.
Potter _{rev}	Wren, R. C., Williamson, Elizabeth M., and Evans, Fred J. (1994), <i>Potter's New Cyclopaedia of Botanical Drugs and Preparations</i> (Saffron Walden: C. W. Daniel Company Ltd.); Reprint of revised 1988 edition.
POWO	Kew Gardens (2024), "Plants of the World," Royal Botanic Gardens, URL: https://powo.science.kew.org .
Trees	Bole, P. V., and Vaghani, Yogini (1986), <i>Field Guide to the Common Trees of India</i> (Bombay, Delhi, Oxford, etc.: World Wildlife Fund – India and Oxford University Press), ISBN: 0-19-561595-6; 4th reprint.
Watt _{Dict}	Watt, George (1889–96), <i>A Dictionary of the Economic Products of India</i> (Calcutta: Dept. Revenue and Agriculture, Government of India), URL: https://tinyurl.com/watt1889 , accessed 28/04/2021.
WDMPP	Quattrocchi, Umberto (2012), <i>CRC World Dictionary of Medicinal and Poisonous Plants: Common Names, Scientific Names, Eponyms, Synonyms, and Etymology</i> (Boca Raton, FL: CRC Press), ISBN: 978-1-4822-5064-0, ark:/13960/s2k3j7xg2ff .

Flora

a large aroid (<i>mahākarambha</i>) name from etymology; see <i>karambha</i> :	unidentified and call it "a variety of <i>kanda-viṣa</i> ." See also 252 :
a root poison (?) (<i>prapuṇḍarīka</i>) according to some, <i>Nelumbo nucifera</i> , Gaertn., Dutt : 110, NK : 1, #1698; 260-261 correctly leave it	adder's mouth orchid (<i>ṛṣabhaka</i>) another member of the mysterious <i>aṣṭavarga</i> group, according to 55. But <i>Microstylis wallichii</i> Lindl.

- is commonly used.
 Identified as the Himalayan
 plant *Malaxis muscifera*
 (Lindley) Kuntze by
[ADPS](#): 371–374, i.e., *jīvaka* :
 agarwood (*aguru*) *Aquilaria*
malaccensis Lam., 3 :
 ‘alas, alas’ (*hālāhala*) unknown. See
 Cf. *Soḍhalanighantu* p.43
 (sub *bola*) = *stomaka* =
vatsanābha :
 Alexandrian laurel (*punnāga*)
Calophyllum inophyllum,
 L. See [AVS](#): 1, 338, [NK](#): 1,
 #425 :
 amaranth (*taṇḍulīya*) see [prickly](#)
[amaranth](#) (*taṇḍulīyaka*) :
 an aroid (*karambha*) probably a
 plant belonging to Araceae,
[GVDB](#): 76 for useful
 discussion. E.g., *Alocasia*
macrorrhiza (L.) G.Don is
 an Old World aroid
 occurring in S. Asia and has
 poisonous sap; any part of
 the aroid *Colocasia* spp.
 chewed or eaten raw can
 cause burning pain and
 buccal swelling, salivation,
 difficulty breathing,
 swallowing or speaking.
 E.g., *C. esculenta* (L.) is
 native to India and has
 these properties,
[WDMPP](#): 1060–62. The
 same source (2847–2848)
 gives the extremely irritant
Pergularia daemia (Forssk.)
 Chiov. as *karambha*. Cf.
piṇḍāluka karambha is
 possibly a syn. for *indīvara*,
[GVDB](#): 76, 44–45 :
 apple (*seva*) see *siñcitikā* :
 apple (*simbitikā*) see *siñcitikā* :
 apple (*siñcitikā*) *Pyrus malus*, L.,
 431. Probably not *badarā* or
sauvīra, idem. :
 Arabian jasmin (*trṇaśūnya*) see
mallikā, 190 [MW](#): 453 says
Jasminium sambac. 190 also
 suggest *ketaka* :
 Arabian jasmine (*mallikā*)
Jasminum sambac (L.)
 Aiton, 300 :
 Arabian jasmine (*trṇaśūlya*)
 probably an alternative
 pronunciation for
trṇaśūnya, 190 :
 arjun (*arjuna*) *Terminalia arjuna*
 (Roxb.) Wight & Arn., see
[HK](#): 738, 61 :
 arjun tree (*kakubha*) *Terminalia*
arjuna (Roxb.) Wight &
 Arn., 61. But these authors
 also point out that this plant
 is sometimes cited together
 with *arjuna*, so it may be
ārtagala (see 39 for
 extensive discussion) :
 Asoka tree (*aśoka*) *Saraca indica*
 Linn., [GVDB](#): 26 :
 atis root (*śṛṅgīviṣa*) *Aconitum*
heterophyllum, Wall. ex
 Royle. See [AVS](#): 1, 42,
[NK](#): 1, #39 :
 axelwood (*dhavaka*) see *dhava* :

- axlewood (*dhava*) *Anogeissus*
latifolia (Roxb. ex DC.)
 Wall. ex Guill & Perr. See
[AVS](#): 1, 163 f, [Chopra](#): 20:
- bamboo (*vaṃśa*) *Bambusa*
arundinacea (Retz.) Willd.:
- bamboo leaves (*veṇupatrikā*)
Bambusa bambos, Druce,
[NK](#): 1, #307. But 380 argues
 for *Setaria glauca* Beauv.:
- banyan (*nyagrodha*) *Ficus*
benghalensis, L.,
[GVDB](#): 356, [HK](#): 748:
- banyan (*vaṭa*) see *nyagrodha*:
- barley (*yava*) *Hordeum vulgare*, L.
 See [HK](#): 752:
- barley ash (*yavakṣāra*) The
 preparation method is
 described at 327:
- barley ash (*yavanāla*) see *yavakṣāra*,
 327:
- bayberry (*kaṭphala*) *M. esculenta*
 Buch.-Ham. ex D. Don,
 which is native to the
 Himalaya, from Kashmir to
 Assam, as well as S. China
 and SE Asia. *Nageia nagi*
 (Thunb.) Kuntze (syn of
Myrica nagi Thunb.), as
 suggested by Singh and
 Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 66), is
 native to East Asia, not
 India:
- bearded premna (*vasuka*) *Premna*
barbata Wall. (← *vasuhaṭṭa*),
 according to
 Cakrapāṇidatta. See the
 discussion by Singh and
- Chuneekar
 ([GVDB](#): 362–363), where
 other candidate species
 such as *Osmanthus*,
Calotropis, and *Trianthema*
 are discussed. Singh and
 Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 363)
 note that when *vasuka* is
 mentioned with *vasira*, two
 varieties of salt are often
 meant (see *vasukavasirā*).
 See also [NK](#): #1299 who
 identifies it with *Indigofera*
enneaphylla, Linn.
 (Birdsville Indigo),
 apparently without
 controversy:
- beautyberry (*śyāmā*) *Callicarpa*
macrophylla, Vahl. See
[AVS](#): 1, 334, [NK](#): 1, #420.
 410 note other
 identifications for “dark
 plant” that include
Operculina petaloidea
 (Choisy) Ooststr., one of
 the morning-glories:
- beggarweed (*aṃśumatī*) see
śālaparṇī, 1, mentioning
 that the pair of these refers
 to [beggarweed](#) and [hare](#)
[foot uraria](#):
- beggarweed (*sthirā*) see *śālaparṇī*,
 458:
- beggarweed (*vidārigandhā*) see
śālaparṇī, 369–370: [7](#)
- beggarweed (*śālaparṇī*)
Desmodium gangeticum
 (L.) DC. See

- Dymock:** 1, 428, **GJM1:** 602, **NK:** 1, #1192; **ADPS:** 382, 414 and **AVS:** 2, 319, 4.366 are confusing. Also called **beggarweed** : 6
- beleric myrobalan (*akṣa*) see *bibhītaka*, 1, 274 :
- beleric myrobalan (*bibhītaka*) *Terminalia bellirica* Roxb. One of the components of **the three myrobalans** (*triphalā*) **GVDB:** 274, 196 : 47
- Bengal currant (*karamarda*) *Carissa carandas* L., 76. One of the shrubs used in the Great Hedge of India :
- Bengal quince (*bilva*) *Aegle marmelos* (L.) Corr. See **AVS:** 1, 62, **Chevillard:** 161, **NK:** 1, #62, i(**MW:** 732a) :
- big poison (*mahāviṣa*) unknown :
- bitter gourd (*paṭolī*) see **pointed gourd** (*paṭola*), cite[233]gvdb :
- bitter melon (*kāravella*) see *kāravellaka* :
- bitter melon (*kāravellaka*) *Momordica charantia* L., 92. :
- bitter melon (*kāravellikā*) see *kāravellaka* :
- bitter melon (*suṣavī*) 442 identify this with *kāravellaka*, q.v., or *jiraka* :
- bitter sponge gourd (*devadālī*) *Luffa echinata* Roxb., 207 :
- bitumen (*adrija*) → *śilājīṭ*. A tar-like, black, resinous rock exudate. See **Mahākośa:** 1, 21 :
- black Bengal quince (*kṛṣṇaśrīphalikā*) 412, on *śrīphala*, synonym of *bilva* fruit :
- black cardamom (*Xhareṇu*) *Amomum subulatum*, Roxb.?. See PVS Caraka 2.734, **AVS:** 1, 128, **NK:** 1, #154, *pace* **GVDB:** 467–468 :
- black creeper (*kālānusārī*) *Ichnocarpus frutescens* R. Br. or *Cryptolepis b Buchananian* Roemer & Schultes. Probably a synonym for *kṛṣṇasārivā* (**GVDB:** 94–95). *I. frutescens* has dark, rust-colored stems, so has been preferred here. However, *Cryptolepis grandiflora*, Wight, also has black stems. Synonym of *kālānusārīṇī*, *kālānusārivā*. *kālānusārya* may be a synonym of *tagara*, itself hard to identify :
- black creeper (*pālindī*) *Ichnocarpus frutescens*, (L.) R.Br. or *Cryptolepis b Buchananian*, Roemer & Schultes. See **AVS:** 3, 141, 145, 203, **NK:** 1, #1283, 1210, **ADPS:** 434. Ḍalhaṇa on SS 5.1.82 identified *pālindī* with *trivṛt* (**turpeth**) and Singh and

- Chunekar ([GVDB](#): 246) supported this as a usual identification :
- black nightshade (*kākamācī*)
Solanum nigrum, Linn., 86–87. May also be the less poisonous *S. dulcamara*, “bittersweet nightshade,”
[K&B](#): 1, 889–892 :
- black oil plant (*jyotiṣmatī*)
Celastrus paniculatus, Willd., [K&B](#): 1.1, 327, [AVS](#): 2, 47–51, 171–172. But [K&B](#): 1.1, 353 also has *Cardiospermum halicacabum* L. “balloon vine,” that we prefer to identify with *hiṃśrā* :
- black pepper (*marica*) *Piper nigrum*, L. See [ADPS](#): 294, [NK](#): 1, #1929. Known to ancient Greek authors (Ball 1888: 341) : 47
- black sarsaparilla (*kālānusārivā*) see *sārivā*; see also *kālānusārī*. Problems about identifying this plant are discussed at 94–95 and 429–431 :
- blackboard tree (*saptachada*)
Alstonia scholaris R. Br. [GVDB](#): 420 :
- blackboard tree (*saptaparṇa*) see *saptachada* :
- blackbuck (*hariṇa*) Antelope *cervicapra*, L. See [BIA](#): 270 [IW](#): 95, 165, *et passim* :
- blade (?) (*kartarīya*) unknown vegetable poison, [GVDB](#): 82; also *karttarīya* :
- blue water lily (*indīvara*) Uncertain; commonly identified as the blue water lily (*Nymphaea nouchali* var. *caerulea* (Savigny) Verdc.,) but may possibly be the plumed cockscomb (*Celosia argentea* Linn.), which is not toxic. But see the useful discussion in [GVDB](#): 44–45. Possibly another name for *karambha*, q.v. :
- blue water-lily (*utpala*) *Nymphaea stellata*, Willd. See [GJM](#)₁: 528, [IGP](#) 790; [Dutt](#): 110, [NK](#): 1, #1726 :
- bluebell barleria (*kuravaka*) see [bluebell barleria](#) (*kuruvaka*) :
- bluebell barleria (*kuruvaka*) Or *kurubaka*. Singh and Chunekar ([GVDB](#): 108) notes that this is sometimes listed as a type of rice, as at *Suśrutasaṃhitā* 1.46.8 ([Su 1938](#): 215). Further discussion at [GVDB](#): 447–448, sub [bluebell barleria](#) (*saireyaka*), where *kurubaka* is said to be identifiable with *baka* and *būka*. Singh and Chunekar ([GVDB](#)) finally propose a red-flowering *Rhododendron*, admitting that this is a novel suggestion : 8
- bluebell barleria (*sahacara*) see

- saireyaka, 427 :
bluebell barleria (*sahā*) see
sahācara, 428 :
bluebell barleria (*sahācara*) see
saireyaka, 427 :
bluebell barleria (*sahādvaya*) see
saireyaka, 428. The two
varieties of *sahā*, small and
large, are likely mudgaparṇī
and māṣaparnī. See also
448–449 :
bluebell barleria (*saireyaka*) A
Barleria, perhaps B. cristata
L. that is particularly
well-known in South India.
Four kinds are
distinguished in ayurveda,
based on the colour of their
flowers. See substantive
discussion at
GVDB: 444–449 : 8
bluebell barleria (*ārtagala*) A
variety of saireyaka, q.v.; 39
argue for Xanthium
strumarium L., “clotbur”
and for Acanthus ilicifolius
Linn., which is not native to
S. Asia. See also 446 :
bottle gourd (*ālābūka*) Lagenaria
siceria (Molina) Standl. See
IGP 645, NK: 1, #1419 :
bread flower (*āsphota*) 41 argue for
Vallaris solanacea (Roth ex
Roem. & Schult.) Kuntze.
This has the right
distribution in S. Asia
POWO: s.v. :
broom grass (*jūrṇāhva*)
Thysanolaena agrostis Nees
171 :
buffalo spinach (*indravallī*) see
matsyākṣaka, 46 :
buffalo spinach (*matsyākṣaka*)
Enydra fluctuans Lour. or
Alternanthera sessilis (L.) R.
Br. 290–291,
POWO: hrefhttps://powo.science.kew.org/taxon/
1s.v. E. fluctuans. Also,
perhaps Cardiospermum
halicacabum L. 88, 141, 172,
394, 471 :
bull’s head (*gokṣura*) Tribulus
terrestris L. GVDB: 144–145,
193. A component of lesser
five roots : 9
bull’s head (*trikaṇṭaka*) → bull’s
head (*gokṣura*) GVDB: 193.
A component of lesser five
roots :
bulrush (*kaṣeru*) “Two species,
Scirpus kysoor Roxb., and S.
grossus Linn. f., are used”
GVDB: 85. Also *kaṣeruka*
and *kaseru* :
bulrush (*kaṣerukā*) see *kaṣeru* :
burflower tree (*kadamba*)
Neolamarckia cadamba
(Roxb.) Bosser, sometimes
“wild chinchona,” NK: 1,
#204, GVDB: 70, Wikipedia
contributors 2025c. Cf.
Mitragyna parvifolia
(Roxb.) Korth, which looks
similar to N. cadamba and
is claimed by some to be the
ancient tree of this name

- (Wikipedia contributors [2025b](#)):
- burflower tree (*nīpa*) see kadamba, 228, q.v. for more detail and alternatives:
- calamine lotion (*amṛtāsaṅga*) → amṛtāsaṅga. Zinc carbonate. See [NK](#): 2, #56:
- camphor (*karpūra*) Camphora officinarum, Nees. or Dryobalanops aromatica, Gaertn.f., nom cons. The latter is native to the Malay Archipelago. See 82, [IGP](#): 253; see also śītaśiva:
- camphor (*śītaśiva*) rarely mentioned. Taken as saindhava or śamī, etc., by some authors, 402. 5.6.18581 glossed it as karpūra, but noticed other interpretations:
- cannabis (*vijayā*) Cannabis sativa, L. See [AVS](#): 1, 356, [NK](#): 1, #442:
- caper (*karīra*) Capparis decidua (Forsk.) Edgew. See [AVS](#): 1, 368, ([MW](#): 255b):
- cardamom (*elā*) Elettaria cardamomum, Maton. See [AVS](#): 2, 360, [NK](#): 1, #924, [Potter_{rev}](#): 66:
- cardamom (*kṣudrailā*) see elā, 128. This expression, “small cardamom” is only used at *Suśrutasaṃhitā* Kalpasthāna 6.17:
- carmarī (*carmarī*) unknown. See 154 which gives no identity. It is only known from this use in *Suśrutasaṃhitā* 5.2.5:
- carray cheddie (*gāṅgerukī*) → *viśvadevā*:
- carray cheddie (*viśvadevā*) → *gāṅgerukī* Canthium parviflorum, Lam. See [AVS](#): 1, 366 f. Or Sida rhombifolia Linn. ([GVDB](#): 372, 444 ff. et passim):
- castor oil tree (*gandharvahasta*) see eraṇḍa. [GVDB](#): 135, [K&B](#): 3, 2277:
- castor-oil (*eraṇḍa*) Ricinus communis, L. See [NK](#): 1, #2145, [Chopra](#): 214:
- castor-oil tree (*vardhamāna*) see eraṇḍa, [GVDB](#): 361:
- catechu (*khadira*) Senegalia catechu (L.f.) P. J. Hurter & Mabb = Acacia catechu Willd. [GVDB](#): 129–130:
- certain minerals (*tārāvitāra*) Unknown. It is not even certain that these are minerals. The variant reading in the vulgate, *tāraḥ sutāraḥ* was glossed by Ḍalhaṇa on 5.3.14 ([Su 1938](#): 568) as follows *tāro rūpyam, sutāraḥ pāradaḥ*, “tāra means silver; sutāra means mercury.”:
- Ceylon iron wood (*kṣīrikā*) Mimusops hexandra, Roxb. ([GVDB](#): 126–127):

- chaff (*kāṇḍana*) The word *kāṇḍana* is not found in dictionaries; *kaṇḍana* is threshing, separating the chaff from the grain in a mortar. Cf. Hemādri's *Caturvargacintāmaṇi* (PWK: 2, 8) (Śiromaṇi 1873: 1, 138: 21, citing the *Vāyupurāṇa*): 41
- champak (*campaka*) *Magnolia champaca* (L.) Baill. ex Pierre, 154:
- charoli nut (*piyāla*) see *priyāla*:
- charoli nut (*priyāla*) *Buchanania lanzan* Spreng. 264:
- chaulmoogra (*tuvaraka*) *Hydnocarpus pentandrus* (Buch.-Ham.) Oken (syn. *H. laurifolius*, *H. wightianus*, etc.), but see the discussion by (GVDB: 188) for the difficulties in identifying *tuvaraka*. See also AVS: 3, 185–188. Definitively discussed by Emmerick (1984: 101–103):
- chebulic myrobalan (*harītakī*) *Terminalia chebula* Retz. GVDB: 466: 47
- cherry (*elavālu*) *Prunus cerasus*, L. See GVDB: 58 for a thoughtful discussion NK: 1, #2037.:
- cherry (*elavāluka*) see *elavālu*:
- chickling pea (*kalāya*) *Lathyrus sativa* L. 84. See AVS: 4, 308, IGP: 901; cf. NK: 1, #1940:
- chinaberry tree (*mahānimba*) *Melia azedarach* L., 302:
- chinaberry tree (*ramyaka*) according to Ḍalhaṇa, this is *mahānimba*, q.v. (334):
- chir pine (*sarala*) *Pinus roxburghii*, Sarg. GVDB: 423:
- choice tree (?) (*varadāru*) unknown. Perhaps *deodar*?:
- cinnamon (*tvac*) *Cinnamomum cassia*, Blume. See NK: 1, #579: 11
- cinnamon (*tvak*) see *cinnamon* (*tvac*):
- cinnamon (*varāṅga*) see *cinnamon* (*tvac*), GVDB: 360:
- citron (*mātuluṅga*) *Citrus medica*, Linn. GVDB: 276, 306. Also spelled *mātuliṅga*, *mātulaṅga*, *mātulāṅga*. See further *nāraṅga*:
- climbing diamond flower (*prapaunḍarīka*) conjectural; see the substantial discussion by Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 261). They note that it is used mainly in eye troubles and frequently with *yaṣṭimadhu*, than which it is has been said to be thicker, and is sweet in taste. Candidates they suggest include *Wendlandia heynei* (Schult.) Santapau

- & Merchant (formerly W. exserta), native to India and *Hedychium flavescens*, Carey. But neither of these plants have any reports of toxicity. Another Indian candidate may be *Hedyotis scandens* Roxb. (syn. *Dimetia scandens* (Roxb.) R.J.Wang) that is poisonous but also used for eye conditions and whose root is abortifacient; the whole plant is used as a fish poison ([WDMPP](#): 1934) :
- clove bean (*śaṅkhinī*) *Ipomoea muricata* (L.) Jacq., Pl. Hort. Schoenbr., 385–386 :
- cluster fig (*udumbara*) *Ficus racemosa*, L. See [ADPS](#): 487 :
- cobra's saffron (*nāgapuṣpa*) → *nāgakeśara*. *Mesua ferrea*, L. See [NK](#): 1, #1595, [GVDB](#): 220 :
- coconut (*nārikel*) *Cocos nucifera* L., 223. Known to ancient Greek authors (Ball [1888](#): 337), although before domestication it was of SE Asian distribution, including Sri Lanka and only the very tip of S. Asia :
- cogongrass (*balvaja*) possibly *Imperata cylindrica* (L.) P. Beauv. 271 describe the debate about this identity :
- coleus (*hrīvera*) *Coleus vettiveroides* K.C.Jacob, 474, where it is stated that this is a synonym for *bālaka*, also a disputed plant. See [POWO](#): <https://powo.science.kew.org/taxon/446211-1>. Some say this is *Pavonia odorata*, Willd., "scented pavonia" :
- colocynth (*indravāruṇī*) *Citrullus colocynthis* (L.) Schrad., [GVDB](#): 46. The two varieties of this plant are discussed by ([ADPS](#): 180–183); the first is agreed to be colocynth, the second is debated but is likely to be a *Curcubitaceae* : [12](#)
- colocynth (*mṛgādanī*) see [colocynth](#) (*indravāruṇī*) [GVDB](#): 46, 318 :
- common mallow (*suvarcalā*) perhaps *Malva sylvestris*, L. A difficult plant to identify, see Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 280, 440–441) :
- common mallow (*sūryāvarta*) *Malva sylvestris*, L. Cakrapāṇidatta and Ḍalhaṇa identify it with *suvarcalā*, itself a difficult plant to identify. Perhaps *Helianthus*, see Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 280) :
- common smilax (*śvadamṣṭrā*) see *śvadamṣṭrā* :
- common smilax (*śvadamṣṭrā*) *Smilax aspera* L.,

- GVDB:** 414 :
 convolvulus (*lakṣmaṇā*) Sivarajan
 and Balachandran
 (**ADPS:** 273–275) suggest
 Ipomoea marginata (Desr.)
 Verdc. or I. obscura (Linn.)
AVS: 3, 237–238 suggests
 Ipomoea sepiaria Roxb.
 (looks like a little boy
 (*putraka*), and generates a
 boy (*putrajananī*), according
 to the *Bhāvaprakāśa*).
 Sivarajan and Balachandran
 (**ADPS:** 273–275) firmly
 reject Mandragora
 officinalis which is
 European; but possible
 consideration could be
 given to Mandragora
 caulescens C.B. Clarke, a
 variant that is known in
 South Asia. Cf.
GVDB: 346–347. **NK:** #1546,
 #2323 suggests Mandragora
 officinalum, Linn., known
 as *putrada* :
 cooked ground grain (*tarpaṇa*)
 described as *mṛd-
 vīkāmādhukādisādhitajalena
 saśarkareṇāloḍitāḥ
 saghṛtakṣaudrā lājaśaktavaḥ*
 (“ground rice grains mixed
 with water prepared from
 grapes, liquorice, and other
 ingredients, sweetened with
 sugar, and combined with
 ghee and honey.”) by
 6.45.14735. See also
 Cakrapāṇidatta on
Carakasamhitā 6.3.155
 (**Ca 1941:** 411). Not a plant,
 as suggested by **MW:** 440 :
 cooked ground grain (*tarpaṇī*) see
 tarpaṇa, **MW:** 440 :
 coriander (*dhānyaka*) Coriandrum
 sativum L., 213 :
 coriander (*kustumburya*) see
 dhānyaka, 113 :
 corky coral tree (*pāribhadra*)
 Erythrina suberosa Roxb.
 See **GVDB:** 245 : 13
 corky coral tree (*pāribhadra*) see
 corky coral tree
 (*pāribhadra*) :
 costus (*kuṣṭha*) Dolomiaea costus
 (Falc.) Kasana & A. K.
 Pandey. See 112, **NK:** 1,
 #2239. Known to ancient
 Greek authors (Ball
 1888: 345) :
 cottony jujube (*kākolī*) Ziziphus
 mauritiana, Lam. See
IGP: 1233, **NK:** 1, #2663; **IGP**
 1233. Cf. **NK:** 1, #1170. A
 member of the notoriously
 difficult *aṣṭavarga*, q.v. :
 country mallow (*atibalā*) Abutilon
 indicum, (L.) Sweet, but
 may be other kinds of
 mallow, e.g., Sida
 rhombifolia, L.. See **NK:** 1,
 #11, **IGP:** 1080, **NK:** 1, #2300,
ADPS: 71, 77, and cf. *balā* :
 country mallow (*sahadevā*) see *balā*
 (**GVDB:** 428). Contains
 ephedrine :

- country sarsaparilla (*ananta-poison*)
 see anantā, with which I
 conjecturally identify this
 poisonous root plant. See
 footnote ??, p. ?? :
- country sarsaparilla (*anantā*)
Hemidesmus indicus, (L.)
 R. Br. See [ADPS](#): 434,
[AVS](#): 3, 141–145, [NK](#): 1,
 #1210. But see [GVDB](#): 13 for
 complications that may
 suggest that it is to be
 equated with *sārivā*, which
 may sometimes be
Cryptolepis or *Ichnocarpus*
frutescens R. Rr.
 ([GVDB](#): 429–431) :
- crape jasmine (*nata*) see [crape](#)
[jasmine](#), [GVDB](#): 215 :
- crape jasmine (*tagara*)
Tabernaemontana
divaricata (L.) R.Br. ex
 Roem. & Schultes. See
[GJM1](#): 557, [AVS](#): 5, 232.
 Synonym of *nata*. But some
 say *Valeriana jatamansi*,
 Jones. See [GVDB](#): 173–174
 for discussion (and
 charming comments on
 brain-liquid testing). Some
 say *tagara* is Indian rose-bay
 or Indian valerian or a
Nymphoides (see
kumudavatī), but there
 remain many historical
 questions about the ancient
 and regional identities of
 this plant See, e.g.,
[AVS](#): 5, 334, 345. See also
[IGP](#): 1147, [K&B](#): 1, 796,
 #758 : [14](#), [22](#)
- crêpe ginger (*caṇḍā*) *Cheilocostus*
speciosus (J.Konig)
 C.Specht ([ADPS](#): 108–110).
 Also called *kevuka*
 ([GVDB](#): 117) :
- crêpe ginger (*kevuka*) *Cheilocostus*
speciosus (J.Konig)
 C.Specht ([GVDB](#): 117) Also
 called *caṇḍā*.
 ([ADPS](#): 108–110) :
- crimson trumpet-flower tree
 (*pāṭalā*) *Stereospermum*
chelonides, (L. f.) A. DC.
 See [GJM1](#): 573, [AVS](#): 5,
 192 ff, [ADPS](#): 362 f, [AVS](#): 3,
 1848 f, [IGP](#) 1120,
[Dymock](#): 3, 20 ff : [50](#)
- croton tree (*nāgadantī*) *Croton*
persimilis Müll.Arg.,
[GVDB](#): 222 : [14](#)
- croton tree (*nāgavinnā*) *Croton*
persimilis Müll.Arg.
[GVDB](#): 222 I have taken this
 as [croton tree](#) (*nāgadantī*)
 because of context in
Suśrutasaṃhitā Kalpasthāna
 5 :
- crow (*kāka-plant*) an unidentified
 poisonous plant apparently
 called “crow.” Singh and
 Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 86) note
 that several drugs named
 after the crow are
 unidentifiable. Thus,
kākamācī is toxic, but this is

- a stretch :
- cucumber (*trapusa*) *Cucumis sativus*, L. See [AVS](#): 2, 231, [NK](#): 1, #731:
- cucumber (*trapuṣa*) *Cucumis sativus* L., 191 :
- cumin (*jīraka*) Three types of *jīraka* – white, dark, earthy, are distinguished, identified as *Cuminum cyminum* L. (cumin), *Carum carvi*, L. (caraway), and *Nigella sativa* L respectively (black cumin/caraway) (169) :
- dark plant (*śyāma*) from the name's etymology. [MW](#): 1024 suggested the *dhattūra* *Artemisia indica* Willd. or *Careya arborea* Roxb. (kumbhī), etc., neither of which are particularly dark :
- datura* (*dhattūra*) *Datura metel*, L. See [AVS](#): 2, 305 (cf. *Abhidhānamāñjarī*), [NK](#): 1, #796 ff. [Potter_{rev}](#): 292 f, [ADPS](#): 132. See Geeta and Gharaibeh 2007 and related literature for the evidence that all *Datura* species are originally a New World genus, introduced to S. Asia in pre-Columbian times. Note that *dhattūra* is mentioned three times the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* (4.17-37, 5.7.52, 53) but never in the *Carakasamhitā* or the *Bhelasamhitā* :
- datura* (*dhuttūra*) see *dhattūra* :
- datura* (*dhuttūrakā*) see *dhattūra* :
- datura* (*kanaka*) see *dhattūra*, 71 :
- deodar (*bhadradāru*) *Cedrus deodara*, (Roxb.ex D.Don) G. Don. See [AVS](#) 41, [NK](#): 1, #516 :
- deodar (*devadāru*) *Cedrus deodara* (Roxb.) Loud. [GVDB](#): 206–207 : 11, 15
- deodar (*dāru*) see *devadāru*, 202 :
- deodar (*suradāru*) see [deodar](#) (*devadāru*) :
- devil's dung (*hiṅgu*) *Ferula foetida* Regel., [GVDB](#): 471–472 :
- dhaman tree (*dhanvaṅga*) → *dhammaṇa*? *Grewia tiliifolia*, Vahl. See [AVS](#): 3, 104, [IK](#), [AVS](#): 1, 386, [IGP](#) 529 (*tiliifolia*) :
- dried ginger (*nāgara*) → [dried ginger](#) (*śuṇṭhī*) [GVDB](#): 221–222 :
- dried ginger (*śuṇṭhī*) *Zingiber officinale*, Roscoe. See [ADPS](#): 50, [NK](#): 1, #2658, [AVS](#): 5, 435, [IGP](#): 1232 : 15, 47
- dried meat (*vallūra*) [MW](#): 929, [Mahākośa](#): 1, 730. The term is used, rarely, in both the CS (1.5.10) and SS (1.13. 16, 6.42.75–76). It is a Dravidian loanword and occurs in the *Arthaśāstra* etc. ([KEWA](#): 3, 167) :
- drum-giver (*lambaradā*) unknown; name from etymology. Cf.

- GVDB:** 348 :
durva grass (*dūrvā*) Cynodon
dactylon (L.) Pers., 205,
where some questions are
raised about white and
green varietals :
eggplant (*vārtāku*) Solanum
melongena L., 366 :
elephant grass (*erakā*) see gundrā :
elephant grass (*gundrā*) Typha
elephantina Roxb., 142–143.
Possibly the plant *phloios*
known to ancient Greek
authors (Ball
1888: 335–336) :
elixir salve (*rasāñjana*) cf. añjana :
embelia (*viḍaṅga*) Embelia ribes,
Burm. f., **ADPS:** 507,
AVS: 2, 368, **NK:** 1, #929,
Potter_{rev}: 113. Poisonous to
fish and mammals,
WEP: 271 :
emblic myrobalan (*āmalaka*)
Phyllanthus emblica, L. See
AVS: 4, 256 : 47
emetic nut (*madana*) Randia
dumetorum, Lamk.,
GVDB: 291–292 and **NK:** 1,
#2091 :
false daisy (*bhṛṅga*) Eclipta
prostrata (L.) L. See 288,
but this is a new-world
species :
false daisy (*bhṛṅgarāja-plant*) see
bhṛṅga :
fermented rice-water (*dhānyāmla*)
→ *kāñjī*, *kāñjikā*, *sauvīra*.
GVDB: 458, **NK:** 2,
appendix VI, #18 :
fern (*ajaruhā*) Nephrodium species
GVDB: 7, uncertain.
Perhbaps Christella
dentata (Forssk.) Brownsey
& Jermy, which is reported
to have folk applications
against skin diseases in
India :
finger millet (*madhūlī*) Eleusine
carocana Gaertn., 296–297;
cf. 216. The common millet
“*rāgi*.” Normally thought of
as of African origin but
known in India in the early
first millennium if this
identification is correct.
Also called *markaṭahastatṛṇa*
“monkey-hand grass” by
commentators :
fire-flame bush (*dhātakī*)
Woodfordia fruticosa (L.)
Kurz. See **AVS:** 5, 412,
NK: 1, #2626. Known to
ancient Greek authors (Ball
1888: 344) :
five roots (*pañcamūla*) Described at
Suśrutasaṃhitā 1.38.66–69
(**Su 1938:** 169). There are
two *pañcamūlas*, the
laghupañcamūla (the
laghupañcamūla and
br̥hatpañcamūla, with
differing properties.
Combined they are called
daśamūla (**ten roots**). See
also **Mahākośa:** 1, 468 :
five-leaved chaste tree (*śephālikā*)

- Vitex negundo Linn.,
[GVDB](#): 433–435. See further
[NK](#): 1, #2603 (cf. use of
leaves), [IGP](#): 1210a,
[MW](#): 1088b :
- flame-of-the-forest (*kiṃśuka*) see
palāśa, 97–98 :
- flame-of-the-forest (*palāśa*) Butea
monosperma (Lam.) Taub.
[GVDB](#): 241. *pālāśa* in some
sources :
- flame-of-the-forest (*pālāśa*) See
palāśa. The variant name
with long initial vowel
appears in Nepalese
manuscripts :
- flax (*atasī*) Linum usitatissimum, L.
See [NK](#)#1495 :
- foxtail millet (*priyaṅgu*) also *śyāmā*.
Setaria italica (L.) P.
Beauvois [GVDB](#): 263–264,
[GJM1](#): 576. The most
widely-grown species of
millet in Asia. Some say
Callicarpa macrophylla,
Vahl. See [AVS](#): 1, 334,
[NK](#): 1, #420. The fruits of S.
italica and C. macrophylla
are similar. See also
[GVDB](#): 413, where the
authors suggest that
priyaṅgu is meant by *gondī*
or *gondanī* and may have
originally been called
gundrabīja :
- foxtail millet (*priyaṅgū*) see
priyaṅgu :
- fragrant lotus (*saugandhika*) A type
of kumuda or utpala,
[GVDB](#): 457 :
- frankincense (*śallakī*) Boswellia
serrata Roxb., [GVDB](#): 392.
Derived from several
Boswellia species, e.g.,
Boswellia sacra Flueck,
Boswellia frereana Birdw.,
etc. To be distinguished
from guggulu :
- fruit of the marking-nut (*āruṣkara*)
see [marking-nut tree](#)
(*aruṣkara*). “āruṣkara =
aruṣkara phala” [ADPS](#): 23;
see also [MW](#): 151 :
- gajpipul (*gajapippalī*) [GVDB](#): 469,
132, syn. *hastipippalī*. A
controversial plant, but the
conjecture of Singh and
Chunekar that Scindapsus
officinalis (Roxb.) Schott is
the more ancient identity is
accepted here : [17](#)
- gajpipul (*hastipippalī*) see [gajpipul](#)
(*gajapippalī*), [GVDB](#): 469,
132 :
- galangal (*galaṅgala*) Alpinia
galanga (L.) Sw. Identified
with [grey orchid](#) in Kerala
([ADPS](#): 398). The name is
borrowed from Chinese,
perhaps via Persian or
Arabic ([Peter](#): 2, 304), and
the name does not occur in
early āyurvedic literature
([GVDB](#)) :
- galls (*karkaṭa*) almost impossible to
identify with certainty,

- 78–80. Perhaps
Toxicodendron
succedaneum (L.) Kuntze,
1891, see [NK](#): 1, #2136.
Sometimes identified with
trapuṣa, which however is
not toxic:
- galls (*karkaṭaka*) see karkaṭa:
- galls (*karkaṭāhvaya*) commonly a
synonym for karkaṭaśṛṅgī,
but there are complications:
see 79–80:
- galls (*kulīra*) see karkaṭaśṛṅgī, 110;
the word is used in the
pañcagavya chapter of the
Atharvavedapariśiṣṭa
(Keith [1912](#): 763):
- gamboge (*suvarṇakṣīrī*) see
svarṇakṣīrī:
- gamboge (*suvarṇakṣīrī*) 441, 461–462
describes the two varieties
mentioned in the
Suśrutasaṃhitā, and the
three mentioned by
Ḍalhaṇa. Candidates are
Garcinia morella (Gaertn.)
Desr. (gamboge) and
Euphorbia thomsoniana
Boiss. The latter plant is
native to Pakistan,
Afghanistan and regions
north ([POWO](#)); its latex is
toxic on ingestion and
dangerously irritant:
- garjan oil tree (*aśvakarṇa*)
Dipterocarpus turbinatus
Gaertn. f. See [GVDB](#): 28,
[Chopra](#): 100:
- ‘gentle’ (*somā*) *Ruta graveolens*, L.,
or *Sarcostemma*
brevistigma, W & A, etc.
See [NK](#): 1, #2179, 2228;
[Potter_{rev}](#): 262:
- giant potato (*kṣīravidārī*) possibly
→ *kṣīraśukla*. *Ipomoea*
mauritiana, Jacq. See
[ADPS](#): 510, [AVS](#): 3, 222,
[AVS](#): 3, 1717 ff: [26](#), [34](#),
[37](#), [40](#)
- ginger (*mahaṣadha*) *Zingiber*
officinale, Roscoe. See
[ADPS](#): 50, [NK](#): 1, #2658,
[IGP](#): 1232:
- gold and sarsaparilla (*surendragopa*)
Unknown. Ḍalhaṇa on
5.3.15 ([Su 1938](#): 568) glossed
surendra as “gold” and *gopā*
as “[Indian sarsaparilla](#).” He
also noted other opinions
that *surendra* was
“[Tellicherry bark](#)”:
- golden shower tree (*karṇikāra*) see
āragvadha, 82:
- golden shower tree (*rājadruma*) see
āragvadha:
- golden shower tree (*rājavarṇka*) see
āragvadha:
- golden shower tree (*āragvadha*)
Cassia fistula L.
[GVDB](#): 37–38, [ADPS](#): 48,
[AVS](#): 2, 11 ff, [AVS](#): 2, 854,
[IGP](#): 215. Known to ancient
Greek authors (Ball
[1888](#): 343). The plant has
many synonyms:
- golden shower tree (*ārevata*) see

- āragvadha, 38 :
golden shower tree (*śampāka*) see
āragvadha :
gourd (*alābu*) *Lagenaria siceraria*
Standl. [GVDB](#): 25. Some say
Lagenaria vulgaris, Seringe
([NK](#): 1, #1419) but this is
not appropriate for
blood-letting :
gourd (*lambā*) see *alābu*,
[GVDB](#): 348. Known as *lambā*
only from *Suśrutasamhitā*
5.2.5. Monier-Williams,
Leumann, Cappeller, et al.
([MW](#): 897): “a kind of bitter
gourd or cucumber” :
gourd (*vallīja*) see *vallīja* :
gourd (*vallīja*) This is a guess.
According to some lexical
sources, syn. for *marica*
([MW](#): 929). See [NK](#): 1,
#1929. Singh and Chuneekar
([GVDB](#): 362) note that
vallīphala may be *kūṣmāṇḍa*,
which I follow. The related
spiny bitter gourd has
poisonous seeds, but not
flowers. Commenting on
Bṛhatsamhitā 8.13ab and
16.24ab, Bhaṭṭotpala glossed
it as *mudgādi*, “mung beans
etc.” :
grapes (*drākṣā*) *Vitis vinifera* L.
[GVDB](#): 208–209 :
greater five roots (*bṛhatpañcamūla*)
described at *Suśrutasamhitā*
1.38.68–69 ([Su 1938](#): 169).
Consists of bilva,
agnimantha, ṭiṇṭuka, pāṭalā,
and kāśmarī : [28, 46](#)
green gram (*māṣa*) *Vigna radiata*
(L.) R. Wilcz. See
[ADPS](#): 296, [IGP](#) 1204 :
grey orchid (*rāsnā*) *Vanda tessellata*
(Roxb.) Hook. ex G.Don,
usually. But *Pluchea*
lanceolata (DC.)
C.B.Clarke, is a more
common identification in
Punjab and Gujarat
([GVDB](#): 337–338); *Alpinia*
galanga (L.) Sw. is more
common in Kerala
([ADPS](#): 398;
[Peter](#): 2, 303–318), though
this is usually identified
with *galaṅga*. As all
authorities note, the
identification of this plant is
debated. Sivarajan and
Balachandran
([ADPS](#): 398–401) note that
sources describe it as having
leaves like cardamom and
sweet-smelling roots and
that “there is great
confusion with regard to
the identity of the drug
rāsnā” : [17](#)
grey orchid (*surabhi*) commonly
identified with *rāsnā*,
including by Ḍalhaṇa. 438
note that “it has been
identified differently in
different places” and list
various alternative

- synonyms including *rāsnā*,
śallakī, *devadāru*, *tulasī* :
grey orchid (*surabhī*) see *surabhi* :
group of eight plants (*aṣṭavarga*) a
list of plants such as *jīvaka*,
kākolī, and *ṛṣabhaka*, whose
identities are unknown or
disputed and guessed :
guggul (*guggulu*) *Commiphora*
wightii (Arn.) *Bhandari*
(*GVDB*: 140), also known as
Indian bdellium-tree. This
is a flowering shrub or small
tree that produces a fragrant
resin. The name sometimes
refers to the plant and
sometimes to the resin.
Known to ancient Greek
authors (Ball 1888: 340).
Sometimes “yellow Indian
frankincense” To be
distinguished from *śallakī* :
gummy gardenia (*pr̥thvīkā*) ←
hiṅgupatrikā, *Gardenia*
gummifera L.f., *GVDB*: 257,
q.v. for discussion :
hairy bergenia (*pāṣāṇabheda*)
Bergenia ligulata (Wall.)
Engl. *GVDB*: 246–247 :
hairy-fruited eggplant (*br̥hatī*)
Solanum lasiocarpum
Dunal. (syn. *S. ferox*, L. & *S.*
indicum L.), 277–278, who
discuss the two kinds of
br̥hatī, which may be large
and small eggplants
(*Solanum melongena* L.).
See also *ADPS*: 100, *NK*: 1,
#2329, *AVS*: 5, 151,
IHR: 429–430 :
halfa grass (*darbha*) *Demostachya*
bipinnata Stapf.
GVDB: 201. Synonym of
kuśa :
halfa grass (*kuśa*) *Desmostachya*
bipinnata, (L.) Stapf.
GVDB: 111, *AVS*: 2, 326 :
hare foot uraria (*kroṣṭakamekhalā*)
see *hare foot uraria*
(*pr̥śniparnī*)
Mahākośa: 1, 246. *kroṣṭaka*
can mean “jackal” *śṛgāla*, as
in *śṛgālavinna*, “a kind of
pr̥śnaparnī)
Mahākośa: 1, 839 :
hare foot uraria (*pr̥thakparṇī*) →
hare foot uraria (*pr̥śniparnī*)
and *rajmahal hemp* (*mūrvā*)
GVDB: 257. A component
of *lesser five roots* :
hare foot uraria (*pr̥śnaparnī*) see
pr̥śniparnī: 6
hare foot uraria (*pr̥śniparnī*) →
sahā? *Uraria lagopoides*,
DC. and *U. picta* Desv. See
GVDB: 257–258, *GJM*₁: 577,
Dymock: 1, 426, *AVS*: 1,
750 ff, *NK*: 1, #2542;
ADPS: 382, *AVS*: 2, 319 and
AVS: 4, 366 are confusing.
Also called *pr̥thakparṇī*. A
component of *lesser five*
roots: 20
headache tree (*agnimantha*) *Premna*
serratifolia L. See *ADPS*: 21,
NK: 1, #2025,

- [AVS](#): 4, 348–352; [GJM1](#): 523.
Many taxonomic synonyms,
including *P. integrifolia*,
corymbosa, etc. :
- headache tree (*vaijayantī*) see
agnimanthā, 382 :
- heart-leaf sida (*balā*) *Sida*
cordifolia, Linn. See
[ADPS](#): 71, [NK](#): 1, #2297. On
the various types of *balā*,
see 270–271, who point out
that there are several
species of *Sida*, e.g., *S.*
acuta, *S. rhombifolia*, *S.*
spinosa and *S. cordifolia*
that may all be types of *balā* :
- heart-leaved moonseed (*amṛtā*)
Tinospora
cordifolia (Thunb.) Miers.,
synonym of *guḍūcī*. See
[ADPS](#): 38, [NK](#): 1, #2472,
624, Dastur #229, 17–18.
Also *amṛta*, m. :
- heart-leaved moonseed (*guḍūcī*)
Tinospora cordifolia,
(Thunb.) Miers. [ADPS](#): 38,
[NK](#): 1, #2472 & #624,
Dastur #229,
[GVDB](#): 141–142. Also
identified as *Cocculus*
cordifolius DC. by
Nadkarni ([NK](#)) and others
(see also the [Tropicos](#)
[botanical database](#)). Also
commonly called *amṛtā* :
- heart-leaved moonseed (*somavallī*)
Tinospora cordifolia
(Thunb.) Miers.
- [GVDB](#): 456. Likely, but
uncertain :
- heart-leaved moonseed creeper
(*amṛtavalli*) See *amṛtā* :
- hedge caper (*himsrā*) *Capparis*
sepiaria L., 471, [IHR](#): 124,
[K&B](#): 1, 109 :
- hedge caper (*kākādanī*) synonym of
himsrā, 88, 471, [IHR](#): 124,
[K&B](#): 1, 109. This name is
not used in the
Carakasamhitā. At 5.7.31
([Su 1938](#): 583), Ḍalhaṇa
glossed *kāḍādanī* as
kṛṣṇaśrīphalikā. vi, 471 note
that they have identified
kākādanī as *Cardiospermum*
halicacabum L.
“balloonvine” :
- heliotrope (*hastīśunḍa*) →
ibhagandhā? *Heliotropium*
indicum, L. See [AVS](#): 3, 136,
[NK](#): 1, #1203 :
- henna (*madayantikā*) *Lawsonia*
inermis, L. See [AVS](#): 3, 303,
[NK](#): 1, #1448, [Potter_{rev}](#): 151 :
- hibiscus (*ambaṣṭhā*) possibly
Hibiscus rosa-sinensis L.
Singh and Chuneekar
([GVDB](#): 18–19) discuss the
confusions surrounding the
identity of this plant, and
especially between this
plant and *pāṭhā*; they must
be different items. Singh
and Chuneekar propose that
ambaṣṭhā is either the fruit of
Hibiscus or the galls of a

- Quercus or Tamarix species.
According to Meulenbeld
1974b: 599, *vanakārpāsī* is
more likely a name for a
hibiscus :
- Himalayan birch (*bhūja*) see
bhūrja :
- Himalayan birch (*bhūrja*) *Betula*
utilis D. Don, [GVDB](#): 287 :
- Himalayan mayapple (*vakra*)
Podophyllum hexandrum,
Royle ([NK](#): #1971),
[K&B](#): 1, 68. But perhaps a
synonym of [crape jasmine](#)
(*tagara, nata* q.v.
([GVDB](#): 354)) :
- Himalayan yew (*sthauneya*) see
sthauneyaka :
- Himalayan yew (*sthauneyaka*) Singh
and Chunekar
([GVDB](#): 458–459) suggested
Taxus baccata L., but that
tree is endemic to the
Mediterranean and not
South Asia. Poudel, Gao,
Möller, et al. 2013 show that
T. contorta Griff., *T. mairei*
(Lemée & Lév.) and *T.*
wallichiana Zucc. are
distributed in the Hindu
Kush - Himalaya region.
The Nepalese name
Thunera is etymologically
cognate with the Sanskrit
name. *T. contorta* is of
medicinal importance, so its
common name is used here :
- hog plum (*āmratāka*) *Spondias*
pinnata (L.f.) Kurz, 37,
[ADPS](#): 36–37. A member of
the *ambasthādi* group :
- hogweed (*punarnavā*) *Boerhaavia*
diffusa, L. See [ADPS](#): 387,
[AVS](#): 1, 281, [NK](#): 1, #363 :
- hogweed (*punarnavā*) see
punarnavā :
- hogweed (*punarnavā*) see
punarnavā :
- hogweed (*varṣābhū*) see *varṣābhū* :
- hogweed (*varṣābhū*) see *punarnavā*.
According to 361, it is
Trianthema portulacastrum
L., but this is mainly known
from Africa and the new
world. The name is often
considered a synonym for
punarnavā :
- Holostemma creeper (*jīvantī*) →
sūryavallī? *Holostemma*
ada-kodien, Schultes. See
[ADPS](#): 195, [AVS](#): 3, 167, 169,
[NK](#): 1, #1242 : 37
- holy basil (*surasa*) *Ocimum*
tenuiflorum, Linn.
[GVDB](#): 438–439. Not always
distinguished from *O.*
basilicum L.,
[WattDict](#): 5, 443 :
- holy basil (*surasā*) see *surasa* :
- honey (*kṣaudra*) Eight varieties of
honey are described in the
Suśrutasaṃhitā ([NK](#): 2,
Appendix 192). *Kṣaudra* is
the product of a small bee of
tawny colour, called *kṣudra* :
- horned pondweed (*śaivāla*) also

- śaivāla, śevāra*. *Zannichellia palustris* L. The uncertainties of this identification are discussed by Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 409). Sometimes identified with *dūrvā* (GVDB: 409). Identified as *Ceratophyllum demersum* Linn. (“hornwort”) by AVS: 2, 56–57x: 23, 38
- hornwort (*jalanīlikā*)
Ceratophyllum demersum, L. See AVS: 2, 56, IGP 232:
- hornwort (*jalaśūka*) → *jalanīlikā*.
Ceratophyllum demersum, L. See AVS: 2, 56, IGP: 232. Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 166) suggest **horned pondweed**. Ḍalhaṇa noted on 1.16.19 (Su 1938: 79) that some people interpret it as a poisonous, hairy, air-breathing, underwater creature:
- horse gram (*kaulattha*) See **horse gram** (*kulattha*):
- horse gram (*kulattha*) *Macrotyloma uniflorum* (Lam.)
Verdcourt, syn. *Dolichos biflorus*, L., *D. uniflorus*, Lam., GVDB: 109, POWO: sub *Macrotyloma uniflorum*: 23
- horseradish tree (*akṣīva*) see *śigru*. 2–3, 27 discusses the contradictions in identifying this plant. I am adopting the most common traditional identification with *śigru* (Meulenbeld 2009: 77, note 12), although *mahānimba* is also likely. The suggestion by Singh and Chuneekar about the name being an erroneous reading for *akṣīra*[*aśmantaka*] cannot stand since the name occurs in a ninth-century *Suśrutasaṃhitā* manuscript. This occurrence in the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* was not known to the definitive study by Meulenbeld (2009: 77–78):
- horseradish tree (*kṛṣṇagandhā*) see *śigru*, 115:
- horseradish tree (*madhukaśigru*) See *śigru*, GVDB: 398–399:
- horseradish tree (*muraṅgī*) see *śigru*, (GVDB: 311):
- horseradish tree (*murūṅgī*) see *śigru*, (GVDB: 311):
- horseradish tree (*śigru*) *Moringa oleifera* Lam. See IGP: 759, GJM1: 603, Dymock: 1, 396, GVDB: 398–399, K&B: 1, 396–399, #336. The definitive study is that by Meulenbeld (2009), who suggested that the name may have denoted pungent, pro-pitta plants, while Spiers (2022) took this

- further, suggesting that "śigru" may historically have referred more generally to plants with a sharp taste, perhaps including garlic :
- hyacinth bean (*śimbī*) Dolichos lablab, L. See [NK](#): 1, #870 :
- hyacinth beans (*niṣpāva*) Lablab purpureus (L.) Sweet (1826) [GVDB](#): 228 :
- Indian aconite (*ativiṣā*) Aconitum ferox, Wall. ex Ser., or perhaps A. heterophyllum Wall. ex Royle, [GVDB](#): 12, [NK](#): 1, #39. Also called "atis roots" or just *viṣā*. A. ferox is also called aconite, monkshood, wolfsbane, etc. A. ferox is extremely poisonous. See also vatsanābha. It grows especially in mountainous Sikkim :
- Indian aconite (*bhaṅgurā*) alternate name of *ativiṣā* or *priyaṅgu*, [MW](#): 744; in SS 5.2.5, I have taken it as the former. 288 have *bhaṅgarā* as a variant of *bhṛṅga*, but that is not toxic :
- Indian aconite (*subhaṅgurā*) see *bhaṅgurā*, it's usual form, without the prefix *su-* "good" :
- Indian aconite (*vatsanābha*) Aconitum ferox, Wall. ex Ser. Cf. [AVS](#): 1, 47 (A. Napellus, L., wolfsbane, is European and now taxonomically separated from A. ferox), [NK](#): 1, #42, [Potter_{rev}](#): 4 f. A. chasmanthum Stapf ex Holmes according to [GVDB](#): 357, but that is distributed in Pakistan, Afghanistan and Tibet, Mongolia and Siberia. "vatsanābha" occurs in only once in the *Carakasamhitā* and thrice in the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* (4.23.11 ([Ca 1941](#): 571), 5.2.5, 6, 12 ([Su 1938](#): 564)) :
- Indian aconite (*viṣā*) see *ativiṣā*, [GVDB](#): 12, 373 :
- Indian antelope (*eṇa*) Antelope cervicapra, L. See [BIA](#): 70 :
- Indian barberry (*añjana*) see *dāruharidrā* Cf. *rasañjana* :
- Indian barberry (*dāruharidrā*) Berberis holstii Engl., [Dymock](#): 1, 65, [NK](#): 1, #335, #685, [GJM1](#): 562, [IGP](#): 141, 203 :
- Indian barberry (*dārvi*) see *dāruharidrā* :
- Indian barberry (*kālīyaka*) see *dāruharidrā* :
- Indian bat tree (*śuṅgā*) → *parkaṭīvrkṣa* according to [Śabdāsindhu](#): 1058; idem also suggests *vaṭavrkṣa*, i.e., Ficus benghalensis Linn. and *āmṛātaka*, Spondias pinnata (L.f.) Kurz. (native to S.E

- Asia but naturalized in S. Asia). Contrasted with *vaṭa* at *Suśrutasamhitā* 3.2.32. Cf. [MW](#): 1081.:
- Indian bdellium-tree (*guggula*) See *guggulu* :
- Indian beech (*nakṭamāla*) *Pongamia pinnata*, (L.) Pierre. See [AVS](#): 4, 339, [NK](#): 1, #2003:
- Indian cherry (*śelu*) *Cordia myxa*, L. non Forssk. See [GJM](#)₁: 529 (2), [IGP](#): 291b, cf. [AVS](#): 3, 1677 f; cf. [AVS](#): 2, 180 (*C. dichotoma*, Forst.f.), [NK](#): 1, #672 (*C. latifolia*, Roxb.). See *śleṣmātakī* :
- Indian cherry (*śelū*) see *śleṣmātakī*, 408 :
- Indian cherry (*śleṣmātakā*) see *śleṣmātakī* :
- Indian cherry (*śleṣmātakā*) see *śleṣmātakī* :
- Indian cherry (*śleṣmātakī*) *Cordia dichotoma* G. Forst., [AVS](#): 2, 180–183. See [POWO](#): *C. dichotoma*; *Cordia myxa* L., according to Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 413–414), although they also suggest *C. dichotoma* (synonym of *C. wallichii* G. Don.) and *C. rothii* (synonym of *Cordia sinensis* Lam.) :
- Indian dill (*śatapušpa*) see *śatapušpā* :
- Indian dill (*śatapušpā*) *Anethum graveolens* L. May also be *Foeniculum vulgare* Mill. See 388 for discussion :
- Indian elm (*cirabilva*) *Holoptelea integrifolia* (Roxb.) Planch. [GVDB](#): 158, who also say that *pūtika* is a synonym; but that must be different than *pūtikā* : 25
- Indian elm (*ciribilva*) see [Indian elm](#) (*cirabilva*) :
- Indian frankincense (*agavṛttikā*) see *śallakī*, according to Ḍalhaṇa's comment on *Suśrutasamhitā* 5.7.29. A variant form of *agavṛttikā* :
- Indian frankincense (*agavṛttikā*) see *śallakī*, 3, 392 :
- Indian frankincense (*gajavṛttikā*) *Boswellia serrata* Roxb.; equated with *śallakī* by some, [GVDB](#): 392. See also *nagavṛttikā* :
- Indian frankincense (*nagavṛttikā*) see *śallakī* :
- Indian fumitory (*parpaṭa*) the ancient plant is probably impossible to identify, and many alternatives are used today, including especially *Fumaria* species ([GVDB](#): 239–240). I have chosen *Fumaria indica* (Hausskn.) Pugsley, which can be poisonous :
- Indian fumitory (*reṇu*) see *parpaṭa*, 339. To be distinguished from *reṇukā* :

- Indian goosegrass (*nandīmukhī*)
Eleusine indica, Gaertn.,
216, 297. Cf. madhūlī:
- Indian ipecac (*payasyā*) Uncertain.
Possibly Tylophora indica
(Burm.f.) Merr. Perhaps a
synonym of [panacea twiner](#),
[giant potato](#), [purple
roscoea](#), and [plants like
asthma plant and Gulf
sandmat](#) (GVDB: 237–238).
Also “curds” when not a
plant: [37](#)
- Indian jujube (*sauvīra*) Zizphus
jujuba Mill., GVDB: 458,
MBG: sub jujuba:
- Indian jujube (*sauvīraka*) Zizphus
jujuba Mill., GVDB: 458,
MBG: sub jujuba:
- Indian kudzu (*vidāri*) see vidārī:
- Indian kudzu (*vidārī*) see also
payasyā. Pueraria tuberosa
(Willd.) DC. See [ADPS](#): 510,
[AVS](#): 1, 792 f, [AVS](#): 4, 391;
not [Dymock](#): 1, 424 f. See
[GJM2](#): 444, 451, [AVS](#): 1, 187,
but [AVS](#): 3, 1719 = Ipomoea
mauritiana, Jacq:
- Indian laurel (*plakṣa*) Ficus
microcarpa, L. f. See
[ADPS](#): 377:
- Indian madder (*mañjiṣṭhā*) Rubia
cordifolia, L. See [IGP](#),
[Chopra](#): 215, [GVDB](#): 289:
- Indian mottled eel (*varmimatsya*)
Almost certainly the
mottled eel. [MW](#): 962c
noted that the *varmi* fish “is
commonly called *vāmi*.” The
“vam fish,” or “বান মাছ (*bān
māch*)” in Bengal, is a
marine and freshwater eel,
Anguilla bengalensis. It is the
most common eel in Indian
inland waters and a prized
food fish (Froese and Pauly
[2022](#)). However, some NIA
languages identify the
“vam” fish with the Indian
Pike Conger, *Congresox
talabonides* (Bleeker)
(Talwar and Kacker
[1984](#): 235, 236):
- Indian mustard (*sarṣapa*) Brassica
juncea, Czern. & Coss. See
[AVS](#): 1, 301, [NK](#): 1, #378,
426–427, without
suggestion of any
poisonous tuber:
- Indian mustard derivative (*sārṣapa*)
this would normally mean
“derived from sarṣapa.”
Excessive consumption of
mustard oil can be harmful.
This seems not to fit in a list
of tuber poisons (SS
5.2.11–17). However, the
Sauśrutaniḥaṇṭu (156) gives
rakṣoghnā as a synonym for
sarṣapā. This can be
Semecarpus anacardium, L.f.,
which has some poisonous
parts (“the black fruit is
toxic and produces a severe
allergic reaction if it is
consumed or its resin comes

- in contact with the skin”
M. Semalty, A. Semalty,
Badola, et al. 2010). But this
is still not a tuber product :
Indian pennywort (*maṇḍūkapaṇī*)
Centella asiatica (L.) Urban.
See [GVDB](#): 290,
[ADPS](#): 289–291, Emmerick
1984: 104–106 :
- Indian sarsaparilla (*sugandhikā*) see
[Indian sarsaparilla](#)
(*śvetasārivā*) [GVDB](#): 430,
436 :
- Indian sarsaparilla (*sārivā*) →
anantā. The *śveta* variety is
Hemidesmus indicus, (L.)
R. Br. [ADPS](#): 434,
[AVS](#): 3, 141–145, [NK](#): 1,
#1210, [GVDB](#): 430; and the
black form, black creeper,
pālindī. *Ichnocarpus*
frutescens, (L.) R.Br. or
Cryptolepis buchanani,
Roemer & Schultes
[AVS](#): 3, 141, 145, 203, [NK](#): 1,
#1283, 1210,
[ADPS](#): 429–430 : 18, 27
- Indian sarsaparilla (*śvetasārivā*)
Hemidesmus indicus, (L.)
R. Br. See [Indian](#)
[sarsaparilla](#) (*sārivā*).
[ADPS](#): 434, [AVS](#): 3, 141–145,
[NK](#): 1, #1210, [GVDB](#): 430 :
27
- Indian sarsaparilla (*śārivā*) see
sārivā, 393 :
- Indian snakeroot (*nākulī*) see
sarpagandhā. See 219 for
discussion of the difficulties
in this identification :
- Indian snakeroot (*sarpagandhā*)
Rauvolfia serpentina, (L.)
Benth. ex Kurz. See [NK](#): 1,
#2099, [ADPS](#): 439,
[GVDB](#): 425; cf. SS 5.5.76–78 :
- Indian snakeroot (*sarvagandhā*)
common spelling in
Nepalese MSS for
sarpagandhā, q.v. :
- Indian spinach (*pūtīkā*) see *pūtīkā* :
- Indian spinach (*pūtīkā*) *Basella*
alba, L. See [NK](#): 1, #318
(*rubra*), [ADPS](#): 489,
[AVS](#): 1, 253, [IGP](#): 129b :
- Indian spinach (*upodikā*) *Basella*
alba, L., var. *rubra*, 53 :
- Indian symphorema (*ananta*) Not
in [GVDB](#) but [MW](#): 25 says
“*sinduvāra*” on no authority
(see [Indian symphorema](#) :
- Indian symphorema (*sindhuvāra*)
see [Indian symphorema](#)
(*sinduvāra*) :
- Indian symphorema (*sinduvāra*)
Singh and Chuneekar
([GVDB](#): 435) settles on
Symphorema polyandrum
Wight as the identity of this
plant. Other authors choose
Vitex negundo Linn. See
further [NK](#): 1, #2603 (cf.
use of leaves), [IGP](#): 1210a,
[MW](#): 1088b. Discussion by
[GVDB](#): 433–435 : 27
- Indian trumpet tree (*śyonāka*)
Oroxylum indicum (L.)

- Benth. ex Kurz.
 GVDB: 172–173. A
 component of [greater five roots](#) : 28
- Indian trumpet tree (*ṭiṇṭuka*) →
[Indian trumpet tree](#)
 (*śyonāka*). *Oroxylum*
indicum (L.) Benth. ex
 Kurz. GVDB: 172–173. A
 component of [greater five roots](#) :
- Indian trumpet tree (*ṭuṇṭuka*) see
śyonāka, 172–173 :
- Indian willow (*vañjala*) see *vañjula* :
- Indian willow (*vañjula*) see *vetasa*;
 see 356 for discussion.
 Doubts about this
 identification go back as far
 as Jejjāṭa (5.8.105592).
 Singh and Chuneekar
 (GVDB: 356) noted that this
 is a tree in the *nyagrodha*
 group and has sometimes
 been equated with *aśoka*
 and sometimes with *tiniśa* :
- Indian willow (*vetasa*) *Salix*
tetrasperma Roxb,
 GVDB: 380–381, q.v. for the
 argument that this is not the
 same as *vetra*. The
 identification of *vetasa* with
Salix caprea L. is unlikely
 since the distribution of that
S. caprea does not include S.
 Asia :
- indigo (*nīlinī*) *Indigofera tinctoria*,
 L. See NK: 1, #1309.
 229–230 propose that this
- may differ from *nīlī*, and be
 rather the *Ipomoea*
hederacea Jacq., “ivy-leaved
 morning glory.” But that
 plant is native to the
 Americas, as are most
Ipomoea species. *I. tinctoria*
 was known to ancient Greek
 authors (Ball 1888: 343) :
- indigo (*nīlā*) see *nīlinī*. Although
 Singh and Chuneekar
 (GVDB: 229) refer to an
 unidentified creeper
 mentioned in *Carakasamhitā*
 Ci.1-4.7, the use in the
 Nepalese *Suśrutasaṃhitā*
 5.6.24 is likely to refer to
nīlī :
- indigo (*nīlī*) see *nīlinī* :
- Indrajao (*indrayava*) see *vr̥kṣaka*
 ([Indrajao](#)) *Holarrhena*
pubescens Wall. ex G.Don
 1837 GVDB: 376, 45 and 84 :
- Indrajao (*vr̥kṣaka*) → *indrayava*,
indrabīja, *kaliṅga*, and *kuṭaja*.
Holarrhena pubescens Wall.
 ex G.Don 1837 GVDB: 376,
 45 and 84 : 28
- ironwood tree (*hema-plant*) see
nāgakeśara, 473 :
- ironwood tree (*nāgakeśara*) *Mesua*
ferrea L. 220 :
- itchytrees (*nicula*) *Barringtonia*
acutangula (L.) Gaertn.,
 GVDB: 224 :
- jackfruit (*panasa*) *Artocarpus*
heterophyllus, Lam. See
 NK: 1, #249, IGP 99 :

jambul (*jambū*) *Syzygium cumini*, (L.) Skeels. See [ADPS](#): 188, [NK](#): 1, #967, [Potter_{rev}](#): 168, Wujastyk 2003:

jequirity (*guñjā*) see *kālakūṭā*:

jequirity (*kākacañcu*) see *kālakūṭā*:

jequirity (*kālakūṭa*) see *kālakūṭā*:

jequirity (*kālakūṭā*) possibly *Abrus precatorius*, L. See [AVS](#): 1, 10, [NK](#): 1, #6, [Potter_{rev}](#): 168. Jequirity contains a dangerous toxin called Abrin in its seeds and to a lesser extent in its leaves, but apparently not in its roots or bulb. Abrin is not harmful if eaten, but an infusion of the bruised (not boiled) seeds injected or rubbed in the eyes can be fatal ([NK](#): # 6). The dose can be quite small. The Nepalese witnesses agree on the feminine form, *kālakūṭā*, while the more normal gender is masculine. The etymology of the name *kāla-kūṭa*, “black-top,” fits with the striking appearance of jequirity seeds. 93 does not attempt to identify the plant. The *Rasaratnasamuccaya* of pseudo-Vāgbhaṭa (21.14) says that the *kālakūṭa* poison is similar to “crow’s beak” (*kākacañcu*), which is a more certain name for jequirity.

The *Rājanighaṇṭupariśiṣṭa* (9.35) gives *kālakūṭaka* as a synonym for *kāraskara*, or *Strychnos nux-vomica*, L., whose seeds are notoriously poisonous. Another hypothesis for the name, which could be translated “time/death-peak” might connect it with Sandakphu mountain, whose name is Lepcha for “the height of the poisonous plant” because of the abundance of *Aconitum ferox* on the mountain:

juice-cooker (?) (*sārapāka*) unknown.:

kadam flowers (*kādamba*) conjectural, based on kadamba. *kādamba* is a hapax, “a kind of flower poison” [GVDB](#): 90. Kadam flowers are not reported to be toxic:

khesari pea (*tripuṭa*) *tripuṭa*(*kalāya*). *Lathyrus sativus*, L. See [IGP](#) 651, [NK](#): 1, #1439:

koda millet (*kodrava*) *Paspalum scrobiculatum* L., 119:

kumkum tree (*kampillaka*) *Mallotus philippensis* (Lam.) Muell.Arg., 74.

[AVS](#): 3, 375–379 describes the different plant used in Kerala, with the variant name *kampippāla* and and

- ADPS: 203–205 cites this as a good example of how Sanskrit plant identities can be misinterpreted in Kerala :
- kumkum tree (*kampilya*) see kampillaka :
- kutki (*ariṣṭā*) Picrorhiza kurroa Royle ex Benth. → *kaṭukā* (*kutki*) q.v. (GVDB: 22–23) :
- kutki (*kaḍurohiṇī*) see *kaṭukā*, 66, 64–65, 66; possibly a scibal error in MS H at SS.4.5.8 :
- kutki (*kaṭukā*) Picrorhiza kurroa Royle ex Benth. (GVDB: 64–65) : 30
- kutki (*kaṭurohaṇī*) → *kaṭukā*, GVDB: 66, 64–65 :
- kutki (*kaṭurohiṇī*) see *kaṭukā*, 66, 64–65, 66 :
- kutki (*tiktaroḥiṇī*) xxx :
- kutki (*tiktā*) see *kaṭukā*, 180 :
- lac (*jatu*) Kerria lacca (Kerr.). See www.icar.org.in/ilri/ :
- lantern flower (*gilodya*) Ceropogia candelabrum L.. or C. hirsuta W. & A., 85, 139 :
- lantern flower (*kalodya*) see *gilodya*, 85, 139 :
- leadwort (*agniśikhā*) see citraka :
- leadwort (*citraka*) Plumbago zeylanica (or indica? rosea?), L. The roots of both rose and white leadwort are very toxic. Cf., *Rājanighaṇṭu* 6.124 and see ADPS: 119, NK: 1, #1966, 1967 :
- leadwort (*pālaka*) see citraka :
- leadwort (*vidyutśikhā*) see citraka :
- lemongrass (*lāmajja*) Cymbopogon iwarancusa (Jones ex Roxb.) Schult. See NK: 1, #176, POWO: <https://powo.science.kew.org/taxon/396948-1>. 350 points out that the identity of this grass remains uncertain, though it one of the two *uśīras*. The Linnean name C. iwarancusa derives from William Jones’ use of the Sanskrit name *jvarāṅkuśa* for this plant :
- lemongrass (*lāmajjaka*) see *lāmajja* :
- lemongrass (*uśīrabheda*) see *lāmajja* :
- lesser five roots (*laghupañcamūla*) Described at *Suśrutasaṃhitā* 1.38.66–67 (Su 1938: 169). Consists of trikaṇṭaka, bṛhatī, kaṇṭakārī, pṛthakparṇī, and vidārigandhā : 9, 20, 46, 54
- liquorice (*klītaka*) Glycyrrhiza glabra, L. GVDB: 123–124 discuss the many difficulties in identifying this plant, and suggest Hygrophila auriculata, Schumach (marsh barbel) and Sesbania bispinosa (Jacq.) W.Wight (prickly sesban), neither of which is noted for toxic roots (as mentioned in SS 5.2.5). Lüde, Vecchio, Sinno-Tellier, et al. 2016

- identify *G. glabra* as a cause of poisoning, sometimes severe, when used as a food, but do not specifically mention the root:
- liquorice (*madhuka*) also *yaṣṭi*(*ka/kā*), *yaṣṭimadhuka*, *Glycyrrhiza glabra*, L. [AVS](#): 3, 84, [NK](#): 1, #1136, [GVDB](#): 329 f. : 31
- liquorice (*madhuyaṣṭi*) see [liquorice](#) (*madhuka*) :
- liquorice (*yaṣṭimadhu*) see *madhuka* :
- liquorice (*yaṣṭimadhuka*) see *madhuka* :
- liquorice (*yaṣṭī*) see [liquorice](#) (*madhuka*) :
- liquorice (*yaṣṭimadhuka*) see [liquorice](#) (*madhuka*) :
- lodh tree (*lodhra*) *Symplocos racemosa*, Roxb. See [GJM1](#): 597, [ADPS](#): 279 f, [NK](#): 1, #2420. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 351–352) notes that there are two varieties, *S. racemosa*, qualified as *śāvāra*, and *S. crataegoides* Buch.-Ham. for *paṭṭikā lodhra* :
- lodh tree (*rodhra*) *Symplocos racemosa*, Roxb. See [ADPS](#): 279, [NK](#): 1, #2420 :
- lodh tree (*śāvāra*) → *lodhra*. *Symplocos racemosa*, Roxb. See [ADPS](#): 279, [NK](#): 1, #2420 :
- long pepper (*kṛṣṇā*) see *pippalī* :
- long pepper (*māgadha*) see [long pepper](#) (*pippalī*) :
- long pepper (*māgadhi*) see [long pepper](#) (*pippalī*) :
- long pepper (*pippali*) see [long pepper](#) (*pippalī*) :
- long pepper (*pippalī*) *Piper longum*, L. See [ADPS](#): 374, [NK](#): 1, #1928, [GVDB](#): 249–250, but cf. [AVS](#): 3, 245 : 31, 47
- long pepper root (*granthi*) Probably → *pippalīmūla* [GVDB](#): 148 :
- long pepper root (*granthika*) see *pippalīmūla*, 148 :
- long pepper root (*pippalīmūla*) see *pippalī* :
- long-stamen *Wendlandia* (?) (*tilaka*) see *prapaunḍarīka*, 183–184. Sometimes thought to be a synonym of *tilvaka*, q.v., but this is probably erroneous :
- lotus (*nalina*) see *kamala*, [GVDB](#): 218 :
- lotus stalk (*bisamṛṇāla*) see *mṛṇāla* :
- lotus stalk (*mṛṇāla*) “Leaf stalk of *kamala*” [GVDB](#): 318 :
- luffa (*garāgarī*) syn. *gargaraka*? *Luffa echinata*, Roxb. See [NK](#): 1, #1517. Syn. *devadālī*, 136 :
- luffa (*jālinī*) see *koṣātakī*, 168 :
- luffa (*kośavatī*) see *koṣātakī* :
- luffa (*kośātaka*) see *koṣātakī* :
- luffa (*kośītakī*) see *koṣātakī* :
- luffa (*koṣātakya*) see *koṣātakī* :
- luffa (*koṣātakī*) *Luffa cylindrica*, (L.) M. J. Roem. or L.

- acutangula, (L.) Roxb.
[ADPS](#): 252–253, [NK](#): 1, #1514 etc. “Kośātakī appears to be used in a general way for all the fruit drugs of the family Cucurbitaceae which have a net-like structure of fibres in the pulp. It thus includes nearly all Luffa species...”
[GVDB](#): 121 :
- mahua (*madhūka*) Madhuca longifolia, (J. Koenig) J. F. Macbride. See [AVS](#): 3, 362 f. Known to ancient Greek authors (Ball 1888: 339–340) :
- maidenhair fern (*haṃsāhvayā*) Adiantum lunulatum Burm f. [GVDB](#): 463 :
- Malabar nut (*aṭarūṣaka*) Justicia adhatoda L. 34, 367 :
- Malabar nut (*āṭarūṣaka*) see aṭarūṣaka :
- malabathrum (*patra*) Cinnamomum tamala, (Buch.-Ham.) Nees. See [AVS](#): 2, 84, [NK](#): 1, #589. Other common names include Indian bay leaf etc., but the plant has an ancient history in the classical world as “malabathrum.” See Ball 1888: 341, who also suggests that the chief source of the plant in India is Assam. See also Wikipedia contributors 2025a. Kokoszko and Rzeźnicka (2018: 581) discuss the abbreviations “leaf” (*φύλλα*, *folium*) in the Mediterranean world that parallels the Sanskrit usage. Kokoszko and Rzeźnicka 2018: 584 note that Dioscorides (fl. 1st cent. CE) stated that malabathrum came from India, although Dioscorides’ description of malabathrum is of a plant like a *Nymphoides indica* (L.) Kuntze, not a tree (Osbaldeston and Wood 2000: 17) :
- malabathrum (*patra*) see patra :
- malaxis orchid (*jīvaka*) “one of the group of eight drugs called *Aṣṭavarga* about whose identity nothing definite is known” (169–170). Identified unproblematically as *Malaxis acuminata* D. Don by [ADPS](#): 367–370 :
- Malay beechwood (*śrīparṇī*) → *kāśmarī*. *Gmelina arborea* Linn., [GVDB](#): 412, 96–97 :
- maloo creeper (*aśmantaka*) Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 27) note that this is the name of two different drugs, *Piliostigma malabaricum* (Roxb.) Benth. or *Phanera vahlii*. (Wight & Arn., 1834) Benth. (non-lactiferous), and *Ficus cordifolia* Roxb.

- (lactiferous). I have selected *P. vahlii* in this context because of its abundance in S. Asia and its Himalayan and Nepalese distribution :
mandarin orange (*nāraṅga*) *Citrus reticulata* Blanc., 223. Genetic studies have shown that the mandarin, as also the Citron, is one of the earliest citrus fruits and the ancestor of many other family members including sweet oranges. Wild mandarin is one of the pure ancestral citrus taxa (Fuller, Castillo, Kingwell-Banham, et al. 2017). The citron is native to south India, the east coast and the Himalayan foothills (ibid., Fig.1). The *C. indica*, Yu. Tanaka, or Indian Wild Orange, is indigenous to Meghalaya (idem). (Wikipedia contributors 2026) includes a useful diagram of genetic descent created by Chiswick Chap. :
mango (*āmra*) *Mangifera indica* Linn. [GVDB](#): 37 :
mangosteen (*amla*) *Garcinia pedunculata* Roxb. ex Buch.-Ham. See [GVDB](#): 20–21 :
mangrove (*bāṇa*) *Avicennia officinalis* L. 272–273 (*A. tomentosa* Jacq., which they mention, is a tropical American and African plant). Known to ancient Greek authors, Megasthenes etc. (Ball 1888: 345) :
marking-nut tree (*aruṣkara*) see *bhallātaka* : 17
marking-nut tree (*bhallātaka*) *Semecarpus anacarium*, L. See [NK](#): 1, #2269, [AVS](#): 5, 98, [ADPS](#): 85–86, 23, 283 :
marsh barbel (*ikṣuraka*) *Hygrophila auriculata*, Schumach. (multiple synonyms, including *Asteracantha longifolia* (L.) Nees), [GVDB](#): 42–43. See *nādeyī* :
marsh barbel (*kokilākṣa*) *Hygrophila auriculata*, Schumach., [ADPS](#): 249; see *nādeyī* :
marsh barbel (*nādeyī*) *Hygrophila auriculata*, Schumach. Only occurs at *Suśrutasaṃhitā* 4.4.32 and not in the *Carakasaṃhitā*. In the [Mahākośa](#): 441, later sources are cited that identify it with “a kind of vetasa,” “a kind of jambū” “mustā,” and so on. [ADPS](#): 249 identifies it with *kokilākṣa* because it grows in marshy ground. See *ikṣuraka* :
medhshingi (*vijayā-poison*) *Dolichandrone falcata*

- (Wall. ex DC.) Seem. This identification is tenuous. The *Sauśrutanighaṇṭu* gives a number of synonyms for *vijayā* (Suvedī and Tīvārī [2000](#): 5.77, 10.143). But one of them, *viṣāṇī* (also *meṣaśṛṅgī*), is sometimes equated with *Dolichandrone falcata* (DC.) Seemann, [GVDB](#): 373 f; [ADPS](#): 518, a plant used as an abortifacient and fish poison ([NK](#): #862):
- Midday flower (*bandhūka*)
Pentapetes phoenicea, L.
 See [NK](#): 1, #1836,
[GVDB](#): 268:
- milk-white (*kṣīraśuklā*) An unidentified plant.
[GVDB](#): 126: see [purple roscoe](#) and [giant potato](#): 40
- monkey (*markaṭa*) name from etymology. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 299) said of *markaṭa*, “an unidentified vegetable poison.” Cf. Suvedī and Tīvārī [2000](#): v.36 for synonyms that lead to the non-toxic jujube tree:
- monkey jack (*lakuca*) *Artocarpus lakoocha*, Roxb. ex Buch.-Ham. See [GJM1](#): 597, [IGP](#) 99, [IPM](#) 3.2338f., pace [AVS](#): 1, 215:
- mountain gardenia (*karaghāṭa*)
 synonym for *karaghāṭaka* and probably *karahāṭa*, q.v.,
- [GVDB](#): 74:
 mountain gardenia (*karaghāṭaka*)
 see *karahāṭa*:
 mountain gardenia (*karahāṭa*)
Ceriscoides turgida (Roxb.) Tirveng. (syn. *Gardenia turgida*), following the suggestion of vi, 77 made partly on the basis of local knowledge in U. P. The ripe fruit of *C. turgida* is poisonous. Other authors suggest identity with *madana*, q.v. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 74, 77–78) noted that *karahāṭa* may be a synonym for *karaghāṭa*:
 mountain gardenia (*karaṭā*) see *karaghāṭa*, as read for *karaṭā* in the vulgate text of SS 5.2.5. Not in [GVDB](#) as such. This poisonous root cannot at present be securely identified, although mountain gardenia has poisonous fruits. Monier-Williams, Leumann, Cappeller, et al. ([MW](#): 255) cite an unknown lexical source that equates *karaṭa* (mn.) with safflower (*Carthamus tinctorius*, L.), but this plant does not have a poisonous root either:
- muddy-bulb (*kardamaka*) unknown; name from etymology.
[MW](#): 258 records variously,

- a kind of “rice, poisonous bulb, snake or erysipelas” with references to *Suśrutasamhitā* and *Carakasamhitā* :
- mulberry (*kramuka*) probably the [mulberry](#) (*tūda*); see discussion by Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 122) :
- mulberry (*tūda*) *Morus indica* L., [GVDB](#): 189: [35](#)
- mung beans (*mudga*) *Phaseolus radiatus* L. [GVDB](#): 310–311 :
- mung beans (*māṣaka*) *Phaseolus mungo* Linn. [GVDB](#): 308 :
- munj grass (*nārācaka*) *Saccharum bengalense*, Retz.?. See [NK](#): 1, #2184 :
- munj sweetcane (*muñja*) *Tripidium bengalense* (Retz.) H.Scholz., 309, 391. Synonym of śara :
- munj sweetcane (*śara*) *Tripidium bengalense* (Retz.) H.Scholz., 309, 391 :
- musk mallow (*latākastūrikā*) *Abelmoschus moschatus* Medik., 348 :
- musk mallow (*ullaka*) kaṭukā or *latākastūrikā*, according to 54; I have chosen the latter identity since *A. moschatus* can cause phototoxic dermatitis (Diedrich, Zweerink, and Elder [2024](#): 621) :
- musk mallow (*ullika*) see *ullaka* :
- myrobalan (*abhayā*) *Terminalia chebula*, Retz. See [ADPS](#): 172, [NK](#): 1, #2451, [Potter_{rev}](#): 214 :
- myrobalans (*pathyā*) *Terminalia chebula* Retz. See [NK](#): 1, #2451 :
- narrowleaf cattail (*guṇṭha*) possibly *Typha angustifolia* L. or a *Fimbristylis* sedge, 142. Not the same as gundrā. Possibly this, or *Cyperus articulatus* L., or *Papyrus pangorei* Rottb., was known to the ancient Greeks (Ball [1888](#): 335–336) :
- natron (*suvarcikā*) Sodium carbonate. [NK](#): 2, #45. Ḍalhaṇa identifies *suvarcikā* with svarjikṣāra 4.8.50 ([Su 1938](#): 441) :
- neem (*picumanda*) see [neem tree](#) (*nimba*), [GVDB](#): 247–248 :
- neem (*picumarda*) see [neem tree](#) (*nimba*), [GVDB](#): 247–248 :
- neem tree (*nimba*) *Azadirachta indica* A. Juss., [GVDB](#): 226 : [35](#)
- nutgrass (*kuruvinda*) Unknown. Ḍalhaṇa on 5.3.15 ([Su 1938](#): 568) glossed the term as [nutgrass](#), but noted other opinions that it was a whetstone or a very special metallic gem. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 108) added that it could be a variety of rice, *ṣaṣṭika dhānya* :

- nutgrass (*mustaka*) Cyperus rotundus, L., 313–314, [ADPS](#): 316, [AVS](#): 2, 296, [NK](#): 1, #782. The root is commonly used in āyurveda and is not poisonous. However some dictionaries list *mustaka* amongst serious poisons, for example *Rājanighaṇṭu* (22 v. 42) and *Rasaratnasamuccaya* 16, v. 80. Its ancient identity as a poison is still in doubt (see 314) :
- nutgrass (*mustā*) Cyperus rotundus, L. See [ADPS](#): 316, [AVS](#): 2, 296, [NK](#): 1, #782 : [35](#)
- odal oil plant (*īṅgudī*) see [odal oil plant](#) :
- odal oil plant (*īṅgudī*) Kirtikar, Basu, and an I.C.S ([K&B](#): 5, 79) also firmly identify *īṅgudī* as *Sarcostigma kleinii* Wight & Arn., a liana well known in the Western Ghats and widely used in āyurveda, including for skin diseases. *Balanites agyptiaca* (L.) Delile, 43 is an African plant and unlikely to be the original āyurvedic *īṅgudī*. : [36](#)
- oleander spurge (*mahāvṛkṣa*) see *snuhī*, [GVDB](#): 302–303 :
- oleander spurge (*nandā*) see *snuhī*, 215 :
- oleander spurge (*nistrimśapatra*) see *snuhī*, 228, 543 :
- oleander spurge (*snuh*) see *snuhī* :
- oleander spurge (*snuhā*) see *snuhī* :
- oleander spurge (*snuhī*) Euphorbia neriifolia, L., or E. antiquorum, L. See [ADPS](#): 448, [AVS](#): 2, 388, [AVS](#): 3, 1, [NK](#): 1, #988, [IGP](#): 457b. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 459) discuss the two varieties distinguished by Caraka on the basis of their spines. Euphorbia all share the feature of having a poisonous, latex-like sap :
- orchid tree (*kovidāra*) Bauhinia purpurea Linn. or B. variegata Linn. (probably the former), [GVDB](#): 120, [AVS](#): 1, 256–260. The fruit of *kovidāra* is contrasted with the mango in Patañjali's *Mahābhāṣya* (on P.1.2.45, varttika 8) :
- paddy rice (*sugandhaka*) see [paddy rice](#) (*śāli*) [GVDB](#): 435 :
- paddy rice (*sugandhika*) see [paddy rice](#) (*śāli*) [GVDB](#): 435 :
- paddy rice (*śāli*) *Oryza sativa*, Linn. [GVDB](#): 395–396 mentioning 33 Sanskrit sub-variety names; [AVS](#): 4, 193 : [36](#), [41](#)
- painted uraria (*prṣṇaparṇikā*) see *prṣṇaparṇī* :
- painted uraria (*prṣṇaparṇī*) *Uraria picta* (Jacq.) Desv. ex DC.

- and *U. lagopoides* DC are both to be used for this plant according to 257–258. See also [IHR](#): 188–190 :
- painted uraria (*śṛgālavinnā*) see *prṣṇaparnī*, according to *Ḍalhaṇa* on *Suśrutasamhitā* 4.5.7 :
- pale Java tea (*arjaka*) *Orthosiphon pallidus* Royle ex Benth., 24, based on *Ḍalhaṇa*’s descriptions, and by Sharma [1982](#): 127, #60. But *Ocimum basilicum* L., according to [AVS](#): 4, 160 :
- panacea twiner (*arkaparnī*) See *arkapuṣpī*, [panacea twiner](#) :
- panacea twiner (*arkapuṣpī*) → *arkaparnī*, *Tylophora indica* (Burm. f.) Merr. [GVDB](#): 23–24. Maybe identical to [Indian ipecac](#), [giant potato](#) and similar sweet, milky plants. See [GVDB](#): 24, 127, 238, 441, 443 for discussion. For discussion in the context of [Holostemma creeper](#), see [ADPS](#): 195 and [AVS](#): 3, 171. The etymology of the name suggests *Helianthus annuus* Linn., but this plant is native to the Americas : [26](#), [37](#)
- peas (*hareṇu*) *Pisum sativum*, L. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 419–420, 467–468) note that two plants are usually meant under this name, but there is no agreement on the identity of the second. Synonym of *satīna*. 468 make an argument for *Symphorema polyandrum* Wight :
- peas (*hareṇukā*) see *hareṇu* :
- peas (*satīna*) see *hareṇu*, 419–420 :
- peepul tree (*aśvattha*) *Ficus religiosa*, L. See [ADPS](#): 63. Known to ancient Greek authors (Ball [1888](#): 338–339) :
- periploca of the woods (*meṣaśṛṅga*) *Gymnema sylvestre* (Retz.) R. Br. See [AVS](#): 3, 107, [NK](#): 1, #1173. See the extensive discussion in 320–323, where the plant *Dolichandrone falcata* (Wall. ex DC.) Seem. is preferred :
- periploca of the woods (*meṣaśṛṅgī*) see *meṣaśṛṅga* :
- phalsa (*parūṣaka*) *Grewia asiatica* Linn., [GVDB](#): 238 :
- piper chilli (*cavikā*) see *cavya* :
- piper chilli (*cavya*) *Piper chaba* Trel. & Yunk. Its identity is disputed, although its geographical distribution may not be as limited as suggested by Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 155–156) :
- plants like asthma plant and Gulf sandmat (*dugdhikā*) synonym of [plants like](#)

- asthma plant and Gulf sandmat (*kṣīriṇī*), 204–205, 127 : 38
- plants like asthma plant and Gulf sandmat (*kṣīriṇī*) various milky plants, perhaps including *Euphorbia hirta* Linn. (asthma plant) and *E. microphylla* Heyne (Gulf sandmat) (GVDB: 127) : 26, 37, 38
- plants like asthma plant and Gulf sandmat (*yavaphalā*) synonym of plants like asthma plant and Gulf sandmat (*dugdhikā*), and plants like asthma plant and Gulf sandmat (*kṣīriṇī*), q.v., 327, 127 :
- pointed gourd (*paṭola*) *Trichosanthes dioica*, Roxb., GVDB: 232–233 : 7
- poison-bench (*viṣavedikā*) unknown; name from etymology. Perhaps syn. *viṣamuṣṭika* or *viṣā* (GVDB: 373) :
- poison-leaf (*viṣapatrikā*) Name from etymology. Perhaps the “leaf of *viṣā*” (but that is feminine). Cf. GVDB: 373, “unidentified” :
- pollen (*reṇukā*) An unidentifiable plant. Perhaps a misreading for *hareṇu*, although this is a long shot. Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 339) suggest, on no authority, the synonyms *vrkṣaruhā*, *māṃsarohiṇī*, or *durvā*, none of which help :
- pomegranate (*dāḍima*) *Punica granatum* Linn. GVDB: 201–202 :
- pondweed (*paripelavā*) Normally a neuter noun. Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 238, 264–265, 409) argued that *plava* and *śaivāla* are the same thing, and may be either *Zannichellia palustris*, L., or *Potamogeton pectinatus*, L. :
- pondweed (*śevāla*) *Zannichellia palustris* L. See horned pondweed :
- pongame oiltree (*karañja*) see *karañjikā* :
- pongame oiltree (*karañjikā*) Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 74–76) discuss complications, but probably *Pongamia pinnata* (L.) Pierre in *Suśrutasaṃhitā* 5.6.3 :
- portia tree (*pārīṣa*) *Thespesia populnea* (L.) Sol. ex. Corr. See ADPS: 352 :
- powdered ruffle lichen (*śaileya*) *Parmotrema perlatus* (Huds.) M.Choisy (1952), although there are some inconsistencies in groups and synonyms. See GVDB: 408–409, AVS: 4, 222–225. The plant

- has a notably complex taxonomic history :
- powdered ruffle lichen (*śaileyaka*)
see śaileya :
- prickly amaranth (*taṇḍulīyaka*)
Amaranthus spinosus L.
See [GVDB](#): 174, [Dutt](#): 321, [NK](#): 1, #144, [Potter_{rev}](#): 15.
Cf. [AVS](#): 1, 121. Amaranth (etym. amṛta!) is a large family, many originally endemic to S. America. A. hypochondriacus L. is sometimes identified with *taṇḍulīyaka*, but A. spinosus L. is better known and attested in S. Asia in the first millennium BCE ([Saraswat 1991](#)). See also [WEP](#): 45: 5
- prickly chaff-flower (*apāmārga*)
Achyranthes aspera, L. See 14, [GJM1](#): 524 f, [AVS](#): 1, 39, [ADPS](#): 44 f, [AVS](#): 3, 2066 f, [Dymock](#): 3, 135: 39
- prickly chaff-flower (*vasīra*) also *vaśīra*. Perhaps Achyranthes aspera, L. [GVDB](#): 362 describes several possible identities, including *sūryāvarta*, [prickly chaff-flower](#) and *markaṭatrṇa*. See also *vasukavasira* ([GVDB](#): 363): 39
- prickly chaff-flower (*vaśīra*) See [prickly chaff-flower](#) :
- prickly-leaved elephant's foot (*gojihvā*) syn. *gojī*.
Elephantopus scaber, L. See [AVS](#): 2, 357. Singh and Chunekar ([GVDB](#): 145–146) argue that *gojihvā śāka* is *Launaea asplenifolia* (Willd) Hook. f. (creeping *Launaea*), a plant with Himalayan to SE Asian distribution : 39
- prickly-leaved elephant's foot (*gojī*)
Singh and Chunekar ([GVDB](#): 145–146) observe that this plant name is unique to the *Suśrutasaṃhitā*. Since the usage is similar to that of [prickly-leaved elephant's foot](#) (*gojihvā*), q.v, it is almost certain to be the same plant. :
- products of the wood-apple (*kāpitta*) a reading in the Nepalese MSS for *kāpittha*, q.v. :
- products of the wood-apple (*kāpittha*) relating to or derived from the *kapittha* :
- purging nut (*dravantī*) *Jatropha curcas*, L. See [AVS](#): 3, 261, [NK](#): 1, #1374. A.k.a. *mūṣikaparṇī*. But *J. curcas* is a New World species :
- purging nut (*mūṣikā*) *Jatropha curcas*, L. See [AVS](#): 3, 261, [NK](#): 1, #1374 :
- purging nut (*putraśreṇī*)
Commonly identified as *nāgadantī*, [GVDB](#): 253 “a

- variety of dantī.” But it appears in a list with *nāgadantī* at *Suśrutasaṃhitā* 5.6.3, and Ḍalhaṇa identified it there as *dravantī*:
- purging nut tree (*mūṣikakarṇī*)
Jatropha curcas, L.
 AVS: 3, 261, NK: 1, #1374, 317. GVDB: 317;
 ADPS: 23–25 discuss this issue well:
- purple calotropis (*arka*) *Calotropis gigantea*, (L.) R. Br. See
 ADPS: 52, AVS: 1, 341, NK: 1, #427, Potter_{rev}: 57, Chopra IDG: 305–308:
- purple calotropis (*khadyotaka*)
 possibly *arka*, *Calotropis gigantea*, (L.) R. Br. See
 ADPS: 52, AVS: 1, 341, NK: 1, #427, Potter_{rev}: 63:
- purple fleabane (*bākucī*) Identified as *Cullen corylifolia* (L.) Medik. ADPS: 69–70, 272. Synonym *Psoralea corylifolia* L. This plant is reported to have hepatotoxic effects (Philips and Theruvath 2024: §3.4):
- purple fleabane (*somarājī*) see *bākucī*, but 455–456 note that two areas of therapy (antitoxin, antileucoderma) may point to two plants being used under this name or a different plant with two active ingredients. A particular alternate candidate is *Baccharoides anthelmintica* (L.) Moench.:
- purple *roscoeia* (*kṣīrakākolī*)
 GVDB: 89 note that many physicians use *Roscoeia procera* Wall. in this context. But the identification is uncertain. Possibly connected to milk-white or giant potato: 26, 34
- radish (*mūlaka*) *Raphanus sativus*, L. See NK: 1, #2098:
- rajmahal hemp (*moraṭa*) see *mūrvī*. Good discussion at
 GVDB: 314–316, 324:
- rajmahal hemp (*mūrvā*)
Gongronemopsis tenacissima (Roxb.) S.Reuss, Liede & Meve (syn. *Marsdenia tenacissima* (Roxb.) Moon),
 GVDB: 314–316, 324. One of the twenty-two drugs in the group *madanādi*. Singh and Chuneekar and
 ADPS: 310–313 discuss the long controversy about the identity of this plant. *Sansevieria roxburghiana* Schult. & Schult.f. (“Indian bowstring hemp”) was preferred by Meulenbeld (GJM1: 590) and the sources he cited, including NK: 1, #2216, K&B: 4, 2457; ADPS: 310 mention this

- identity as being local to Bengal, but note that that plant is not a creeper, as *mūrvā* should be : [20](#)
- rajmahal hemp (*mūrvī*)
 Gongronemopsis tenacissima (Roxb.)
 S.Reuss, Liede & Meve (syn. Marsdenia tenacissima (Roxb.) Wight et Arn.)
 Good discussion at [GVDB: 314–316, 324](#). See *mūrvī* :
- rajmahal hemp (*nirdahanī*) see *mūrvī*, [227](#) :
- rajmahal hemp (*nirdahyānya*) the variant of *nirdahanī* appearing in the Nepalese version of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā*. The term does not appear in the *Sauśrutanighaṇṭu* (Suvedī and Tivārī [2000](#)). See *mūrvī* :
- rattan (*vetra*) Calamus rotang, L. See [AVS: 1, 330](#), [NK: 1, #413](#). Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB: 381](#)) prefer C. tenuis, Roxb., which is also native to S. and S.E. Asia :
- red gourd (*bimbī*) Coccinia indica, W. & A. See PVS 1994.4.715; [NK: 1, #534](#) :
- red physic nut (*dantī*)
 Baliospermum solanifolium (Burm.) Suresh, 200 :
- red wisteria (*antrapācaka*) a plant poison, perhaps Sesbania grandiflora (L.) Poiret ([MW: 44](#)) (source unknown). S. grandiflora is normally *agastya* ([GVDB: 3](#)) :
- resin of chir pine (*śrīveṣṭaka*) resin of Pinus roxburghii Sargent [412](#) :
- resin of white dammer tree (*sarjarasa*) [424–425](#). See *sarja* :
- ribbed gourd (*karkoṭaka*) Luffa acutangula, (L.) Roxb.? (Mormodica cochinchinensis, Spreng.? Cf. Luffa tuberosa). See [AVS: 3, 347](#) ([NK: 1, #1640](#) [1643](#); [NK: 1, #1520](#)) :
- rice grains (*taṇḍula*) Oryza sativa, Linn. Same as [paddy rice](#) (*śālī*) [GVDB: 174](#); or just "grains" :
- rice-grain chaff (*śālitaṇḍulakāṇḍana*) See [chaff](#) :
- River Crinum Lily (*kandala*) possibly the flowers of *kandalī* ([MW: 249](#)), which plant is tentatively identified by [71–72](#) as Crinum defixum Ker.-Gawl. :
- River Crinum Lily (*kandalī*) tentatively identified by [71–72](#) as Crinum defixum Ker.-Gawl. :
- rosha grass (*dhyāmaka*) Cymbopogon martinii (Roxb.) Wats. See

- AVS: 2, 285, NK: 1, #177 :
royal jasmine (*jāti*) see *mālatī*, 166 :
royal jasmine (*mālatī*) *Jasminium grandiflorum*, L. See NK: 1, #1364, ADPS: 285–288 :
royal jasmine (*sumanā*) see *mālatī*, 437 :
sacred fig (*pippala*) *Ficus religiosa* L., 248 etc. :
sacred lotus (*kamala*) *Nelumbo nucifera*, Gaertn., GVDB: 73–74, Dutt: 110, NK: 1, #1698 :
sacred lotus (*padma*) see *kamala*, 235–236 :
safflower (*kusumbha*) *Carthamus tinctorius* L. 113 :
saffron (*bāhlīka*) syn. of saffron (*kuṅkuma*), q.v., GVDB: 273–274 :
saffron (*kuṅkuma*) *Crocus sativus* Linn., GVDB: 100. On the history of confusions between saffron and turmeric, see Cox 2011 : 42
sage-leaved alangium (*aṅkolla*) *Alangium salvifolium* (Linn. f.) Wang., GVDB: 5–6. See also AVS: 1, 77; cf. NK: 1, #88 :
sage-leaved alangium (*aṅkoṭa*) see *aṅkolla* :
sage-leaved alangium (*aṅkoṭha*) see *aṅkolla* :
sāhya (?) (*sāhya*) unknown and not cited in reference sources available to me. Perhaps a wrong reading for साङ्ग or similar (also unknown) :
sal (*śālasāra*) see *śāla* :
sal group of trees (*śālasārādi*) *śālasārādi* is a group (*gaṇa*) of twenty-three trees listed at 1.38.8–9 (Su 1938: 165), Mahākośa: 1, 898 :
sal tree (*śāla*) *Shorea robusta* Roth, GVDB: 394 :
sal tree (*śālā*) *Shorea robusta*, Gaertn.f. See AVS: 5, 124 :
sandalwood (*candana*) *Santalum album*, L. See ADPS: 111, NK: 1, #2217. See 152–153 for discussion of types, including white and red (*Pterocarpus santalinus* (L.f.)) : 51
sandan (*tiniśa*) *Ougeinia oojeinensis* (Roxb.) Hochr. GVDB: 181, q.v. for discussion about whether *tiniśa* and *syandana* are to be separated. If other trees are in the frame for either name, Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB) suggest *Lagerstroemia parviflora* Roxb. (*sidhraka/siddhaka*) and *L. flos-reginae* Retz. (*jārula* by some). See GVDB: 432 :
sappan wood (*pataṅga*) *Caesalpinia sappan*, L. See AVS: 1, 323, AVS: 2, 847 f :
sappanwood (*pattāṅga*) See sappanwood (*pattāṅga*) :
sappanwood (*pattāṅga*) Also

- pattaṅga*. *Caesalpinia*
sappan, L. [AVS](#): 1, 323,
[K&B](#): 2, 847 f, [GVDB](#): 234 :
[42](#)
- scarlet mallow (*bandhujīva*)
Pentapetes phoenicea, L.
[NK](#): #1836, [GVDB](#): 268 :
- scented pavonia (*bālaka*) *Pavonia*
odorata, Willd. See
[ADPS](#): 498, [NK](#): 1, #1822.
But 273 argue for *Coleus*
vettiveroides K.C.Jacob; see
hrīvera :
- scented pavonia (*toya*) → *bālaka*?
Pavonia odorata, Willd.
[ADPS](#): 498, [NK](#): 1, #1822 :
- scramberry (*tālīsa*) see *tālīsa* :
- scramberry (*tālīsapatra*) see *tālīsa* :
- scramberry (*tālīsa*) Singh and
Chunekar ([GVDB](#): 179,
458–459) discusses the
several identifications and
regional differences in
identifying this plant. *Taxus*
baccata Linn. is a common
candidate, as is *Flacourtia*
jangomas (Lour.) Raeusch.
(scramberry) :
- screw-pine (*ketaka*) *Pandanus*
odorifer (Forssk.) Kuntze,
116 (not *P. tectorius* that is
from eastern
Indonesia–PNG–Australia) :
- scutch grass (*granthilā*) see *dūrvā*,
[Mahākośa](#): 1, 303, citing the
Rājanighaṇṭu. It should be
an aromatic in this context.
Monier-Williams, Leumann,
- Cappeller, et al.: 371 said
“two kinds of *Dūrvā* grass
and of a kind of *Cyperus*”
on lexical authority,
perhaps also the
Rājanighaṇṭu where it is
listed amongst
sweet-smelling plants.
Other sources identify it as
Cissus quadrangularis, L.,
i.e., Veldt grape (Ś. Gupta
[1887](#): 272), or bilva :
- sedge (*kuṭannaṭa*) → *plava*, *tagara*, or
śyonāka, according to
commentators
([GVDB](#): 102–103). Singh
and Chunekar leans
towards the *plava*, but that
plant too is difficult to
identify. Various sources
identify *kuṭannaṭa* as
Cyperus rotundus L., *C.*
scariosus R. Br., *Oroxylum*
indicum (L.) Benth. ex Kurz
(= *Bignonia Indica* L.) or
even *Cinnamomum verum*
J.Presl. The *Cyperus* genus
comprises about 700 species
of sedges, and I have chosen
“sedge” as a generic
indication of the likely
identity of this plant : [43](#)
- sedge (*kuṭannaṭā*) see *kuṭannaṭa* :
- sedge (*plava*) see [sedge](#) (*kuṭannaṭa*) :
- sesame (*tila*) *Sesamum indicum* L.
[GVDB](#): 183. Known to
ancient Greek authors (Ball
[1888](#): 344) :

- sesame oil (*taila*) *Sesamum indicum* L. [GVDB](#): 183 :
- shami tree (*śamī*) *Prosopis cineraria* (L.) Druce [GVDB](#): 390 :
- sheep (*urabhra*) *Ovis orientalis*, Gmelin?. See [BIA](#) 249 :
- sickle senna (*cakramarda*) *Senna tora* (L.) Roxb., 150. See a useful discussion of the taxonomic issues surrounding this plant in Wikipedia contributors [2025d](#) :
- sickle senna (*prapunṇāḍa*) as spelled by 260; see *prapunāṭa* :
- sickle senna (*prapunāṭa*) see *cakramarda*. Listed as *prapunṇāḍa* in 260 noting synonymy with *cakramarda* :
- silk-cotton tree (*śālmālī*) *Bombax malabarica*. See [Issar](#): 152 :
- silky *Dalbergia* (*gaṇḍīra*) 133–135 gives a long discussion, asserting that this name refers to at least three plant species, including plants like *śirīṣa* like *Albizia julibrissin* Durazz., 1772 non sensu Baker, 1876 (originally from Persia) or *Dalbergia sericea* G.Don. Other possibilities include *Coleus amboinicus* Lour, or a *Mentha* variety. I have chosen D. *sericea* because it is strongly distributed in S. Asia :
- siris (*śirīṣa*) *Albizia lebbbeck*, Benth. See [AVS](#): 1, 81, [NK](#): 1, #91, [GVDB](#): 399–400. Cf. [white siris](#) :
- siris seeds (*śirīṣamāṣaka*) *Albizia lebbbeck*, Benth. See [AVS](#): 1, 81, [NK](#): 1, #91 :
- small-flowered crape myrtle (*siddha*) *Lagerstroemia parviflora* Roxb., see [small-flowered crape myrtle \(sidhraka\)](#), [GVDB](#): 432 :
- small-flowered crape myrtle (*siddhaka*) *Lagerstroemia parviflora* Roxb., see [small-flowered crape myrtle \(sidhraka\)](#), [GVDB](#): 432 :
- small-flowered crape myrtle (*siddhraka*) see [small-flowered crape myrtle \(sidhraka\)](#) :
- small-flowered crape myrtle (*sidhraka*) *Lagerstroemia parviflora* Roxb., [GVDB](#): 432 : [44](#)
- smooth angelica (*coraka*) *Angelica glauca* Edgw. [GVDB](#): 161. Distribution: Afghanistan, Himalaya, western Tibet ([POWO](#)). Edgeworth even recorded the indigenous name “chura” (Edgeworth [1851](#): 53) :
- smooth angelica (*taskara*) see *coraka*, 176 :
- snake mallow (*mahābalā*) see *nāgabālā* and cf. *sahadevā*. See also [NK](#): 1, #2301, [ADPS](#): 74, Index Kewensis :

- snake mallow (*nāgabalā*) perhaps
Sida veronicaefolia Lam.;
 see 221 for discussion :
- snake-killer (?) (*sarpaghāti*)
 unknown. :
- snakeroot (*sugandhā*) →
sarpagandhā Rauvolfia
 serpentina Benth. ex. Kurz.
 See *sarpagandhā*. But may be
Aristolochia indica Linn.
 Has been identified with
nākulī, or *gandhanākulī*. See
 (GVDB: 219, 436) :
- snowball plant (*ajāśṛṅgī*) Singh and
 Chunekar (GVDB: 8) said
 that this is a common
 climber of Suśruta's
vallīpañcamūla group
 (1.38.72 (Su 1938: 169)) and
 suggested that it may be
Saussurea gossypiphora. If
 it is a synonym of *uttamāraṇī*
 it may be *Pergularia daemia*
 (Forssk.) Chiov. (trellis
 vine) (GVDB: 49) :
- soda crystals (*suvarjikā*) Sodium
 carbonate. See NK: 2, #45 :
- soma (*raivata*) a synonym for soma,
 339 :
- spiked ginger lily (*śaṭī*) *Hedychium*
spicatum Sm. in A. Rees,
 GVDB: 386–387. Also
 sometimes *śaṭhī* :
- spikenard (*jaṭā*) see jaṭāmāṃsī :
- spikenard (*jaṭāmāṃsī*)
Nardostachys jatamansi
 (D. Don) DC, GVDB: 163.
 See also NK: 1, #1691.
- Known to ancient Greek
 authors (Ball
 1888: 343–344) :
- spikenard (*māṃsī*) see jaṭāmāṃsī :
- spikenard (*nalada*) see jaṭāmāṃsī :
- spiny bitter gourd (*karkāruka*)
Momordica cochinchinensis
 (Lour.) Spreng., (Thunb.)
 Cogn. See AVS: 2, 1135, IGP
 754 (or Benincasa
hispida? AVS: 2, 1127; cf.
 AVS: 1, 261). M
cochinchinensis has
 poisonous seeds
 (NEH: 279) : 19
- spurge (*nandanā*) an unknown
 poisonous plant, a.k.a.
 (equally obscurely)
udīmānaka, GVDB: 215
 (where it is m.). Perhaps a
 synonym of *snuhī*, like
nandā :
- spurge (*saptalā*) Singh and
 Chunekar (GVDB: 421–422)
 discuss the four candidates
 for this plant, three of
 which are Euphorbias :
- strychnine tree (*viṣamuṣṭika*)
Strychnos nux vomica Linn.,
 GVDB: 373 :
- sugar (*sitā*) Ḍalhaṇa makes this
 equation at 1.37.25
 (Su 1938: 162) :
- sugar (*śarkara*) *Saccharum*
officinarum, Linn.
 NK: #2182 :
- sugar (*śarkarā*) see śarkara :
- sugar (*śarkkarā*) see śarkara :

- roots of *śara*, *ikṣu*, *darbha*, *kāśa*, and *śālī*, but in the *Suśrutasamhitā* (1.38.76 ([Su 1938](#): 169)) they are *kuśa*, *kāśa*, *nala*, *darbha* and *kāṇḍekṣu*, and are recommended for urinary ailments etc. :
- the four *jāta* drugs (*caturjāta*) a group of four drugs, *tvac*, *patra*, *elā*, and *nāgakeśara* 152 :
- the four *jāta* drugs (*caturjātaka*) see *caturjāta* :
- the four *jāta* drugs (*cāturjāta*) see *caturjāta* :
- the greater five roots (*mahāpañcamūlī*) see *br̥hatpañcamūla* :
- the lesser five roots (*pañcamūlī*) see *pañcamūla* :
- the three myrobalans (*triphalā*) [chebulic myrobalan](#) [beleric myrobalan](#) and [emblic myrobalan](#) (*harītakī* *bibhītaka* and *āmalaka*) One of the most-often mentioned drugs in the *Br̥hatrayī* [GVDB](#): 194–196 : 7
- the three pungent drugs (*kaṭutrika*) see *trikaṭu* :
- the three pungent drugs (*trikaṭu*) [dried ginger](#), [long pepper](#), and [black pepper](#) (*śuṇṭhī*, *pippalī*, and *marica*) [GVDB](#): 193 :
- the three pungent drugs (*vyoṣa*) see *trikaṭu*, 382–383 :
- the two types of clitoria (*śvete*) see *śvetā* :
- the two types of turmeric (*haridre*) see *haridrā* and *dāruharidrā*, 465–466 :
- thorn tree (?) (*sanakhā*) unidentified plant or tree. Perhaps “thorny?” The MS readings at *Suśrutasamhitā* 5.6.15 are unambiguous; the vulgate reads *nāgara* “ginger,” at this location :
- three heating spices (*tryūṣaṇa*) *śuṇṭhī* (Dried ginger) *Zingiber officinale*, Roscoe. [ADPS](#): 50, [NK](#): 1, #2658, [AVS](#): 5, 435, [IGP](#) 1232, *pippalī* (long pepper) *Piper longum*, L. [ADPS](#): 374, [NK](#): 1, #1928, and *marica* (black pepper) *Piper nigrum*, L. [ADPS](#): 294, [NK](#): 1, #1929 :
- three-leaf soapberry (*ariṣṭaka*) *Sapindus trifolius* L. ([GVDB](#): 22) :
- three-leaved caper (*varuṇa*) *Crataeva magna* (Lour.) DC. See [AVS](#): 2, 202; cf. [NK](#): 1, #696 :
- three-leaved caper (*varuṇaka*) see *varuṇa* :
- toddy palm (*tāla*) *Borassus flabellifer* L., 178 :
- toothbrush tree (*pīlu*) *Salvadora oleoides* Decne. 251. Singh and Chuneekar also mention *S. persica* L., but that is

- native to Africa, Syria and the Arabian peninsula (POWO: taxon/urn:lsid:ipni.org:names:7931811-1). Also commonly called Vann :
- toothed-leaf limonia (*surasī*)
Naringi crenulata (Roxb.)
Nicolson (formerly Limonia crenulata Roxb.),
GVDB: 439 :
- top layer of fermented liquor (*surāmaṇḍa*) K&B: 2, 502, NK: 2, appendix VI, #49, McHugh 2021: 39 :
- tree cotton (*kārpāsa*) Gossypium arboreum L. ADPS: 231, *pace* the identifications of Singh and Chunekar (GVDB: 92, 247), since *G. barbadense* L. is native to South America and *G. herbaceum* L. is native to Africa :
- tree cotton (*picu*) See *kārpāsa* :
- tree of heaven (*arala*) probably *Alianthus excelsa* Roxb.,
GVDB: 21–22 : 48
- tree of heaven (*aralu*) see [tree of heaven](#) (*arala*) :
- turmeric (*gaūrī*) *Curcuma longa*, L. See ADPS: 169, AVS: 2, 259, NK: 1, #750 :
- turmeric (*haridrā*) *Curcuma longa* Linn. GVDB: 465. On the history of confusions between saffron and turmeric, see Cox 2011 :
- turmeric (*niśā*) see *haridrā*. Note that when mentioned in dual or with another synonym of *haridrā*, then *niśā* should be interpreted as *dāruharidrā*, 227 :
- turmeric (*niśyā*) see *haridrā*. This is MS Kathmandu KL 699's spelling of the more usual spelling *niśā* :
- turmeric (*rajanī*) *Curcuma longa*, L. ADPS: 169, AVS: 2, 259, NK: 1, #750 :
- turpeth (*saralā*) Possibly white *trivṛt*, q.v., according to 423. Not to be confused with *saralā* :
- turpeth (*trivṛt*) *Operculina turpethum* (Linn.) Silva Manso = *Ipomoea turpethum* R. Br. GVDB: 197. : 7
- turpeth (*trivṛtā*) see *trivṛt* :
- turpeth (*trivṛt*) The common spelling in Nepalese MSS of *trivṛt* :
- two kinds of salt (*vasukavasira*) See the discussion by Singh and Chunekar (GVDB: 362–363), who note that when *vasuka* is mentioned together with *vasira*, two varieties of salt are often meant (see *vasukavasirā*) :
- unknown fruit poison (*veṇuka*) see *veṇukā* :
- unknown fruit poison (*veṇukā*) *Bambusa bambos*, Druce?. See NK: 1, #307, 380. The

- Nepalese transmission has the m. *veṇuka*, not the f. *veṇukā* Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 380) note that this is an unknown fruit-poison :
- various kinds of honey (*madhuvara*)
Suśrutasamhitā's eight categories of honey. See *Suśrutasamhitā* 1.45.132 and Dutt: 278–279 :
- velvet bean (*kapikacchu*) see *svayamguptā*, 72 :
- velvet bean (*svayamguptā*) *Mucuna pruriens* (L.) DC., GVDB: 461, who say that the plant is known in the *Carakasamhitā* but not the *Suśrutasamhitā*. Watt (Watt_{Dict}: 5, 286) noted that the English names Cowhage or Cowitch are derived from the Hindi name of *M. pruriens*, *Kiwach*, Skt. *kapikacchu*, supported by Yule and Burnell (1903: 268) :
- velvet bean (*ārṣabhī*) see *ṛṣabhī* and *svayamguptā*.
Mahākośa: 1, 94, citing the *Rājanighaṇṭu* 3.50, 201 :
- velvet bean (*ṛṣabhī*) see *svayamguptā*, MW: 226, 56 :
- velvet-leaf (*pāṭhā*) *Cissampelos pariera*, L. See ADPS: 366, NK: 1, #592, GJM1: 573, AVS: 1, 95; cf. AVS: 2, 277 :
- velvet-mite (*indragopa*) *Kerria lacca* (Kerr.). Lienhard 1978 :
 verbena (*bhārgī*) see [verbena](#) (*bhārgī*) :
 verbena (*bhārgī*) → *phañjī*.
Clerodendrum serratum (L.) Moon or C. *serratum*; see AVS: 2, 121, ADPS: 87 : 49
 verbena (*phañjī*) *Clerodendrum serratum*, L. See AVS: 2, 121, ADPS: 87 :
- vetiver (*khasa*) see *uśīra* :
- vetiver (*uśīra*) *Chrysopogon zizanioides* (L.) Roberty, also called “khus.” NK: 1, #180, 54 identify it as vetiver. Commentators normally identify two types of *uśīra*, the other being the same as *lāmajja* :
- vetiver and lemon grass (?) (*uśīre*) “the two *uśīras*,” perhaps *uśīra* and *uśīrabheda* :
- viburnum (*tilva*) see *tilvaka* :
- viburnum (*tilvaka*) *Viburnum nervosum* D.Don. In their thoughtful article, Singh and Chuneekar (GVDB: 185–186) separate *tilvaka* from *lodhra*, a conflation they attribute to Dṛḍhabala. They identify V. *nervosum* because of its use under a similar local name in Garhwal and Gangotri and the match with its purging properties mentioned in ayurvedic

- literature. [AVS](#): 5, 219 makes the same separation, noting that in Kerala the plant *Jatropha curcas* L. is used. But that is a native of the new world. Cf. many *Viburnum* varieties listed by Griffiths ([IGP](#): 1200 ff.). [POWO](#) confirms that *V. nervosum* has an appropriate Himalayan distribution. *Tilvaka* is also sometimes wrongly considered to be a synonym of *tilaka*, 185–186 :
- viburnum extract (*tailvaka*) see *tilvaka*, 185, also a ghee compound of *tilvaka* :
- ‘Virāṭa’s plant’ (*vairāṭaka*) unknown plant with a poisonous tuber, 382. The Virāṭas are tribal peoples :
- water chestnut (*śṛṅgāṭaka*) *Trapa bispinosa* Roxb. 406 :
- water hyssop (*brāhmī*) *Bacopa monnieri* (L.) Pennel, 281, who describe the substitutes that are mistakenly used in some places :
- water snowflake (*kumudavati*) see *kumudavatī* :
- water snowflake (*kumudavatī*) This is an unidentifiable plant whose name means, etymologically, “with lilies.” [MW](#): 292 gives *Nymphoides indica* (L.) Kuntze (formerly *Villarsia indica*) on no authority; I have used the common name of *N. indica* as a possibility, but this is not known to be poisonous; on the contrary, it is used medicinally (Khan et al. [2018](#)). *N. indica* is illustrated on p. 6 of the Voynich manuscript. Khan et al. ([2018](#)) assert that this is the same plant as *tagara*, although this is not a widely-held view (see *tagara*) :
- watered buttermilk (*udaśvit*) [MW](#): 183 :
- watermelon (*kāḷindaka*) *Citrullus lanatus* (Thunb.) Matsum & Nak. See [IGP](#) 257, [NK](#): 1, #596, [AVS](#): 2, 1149 :
- wax gourd (*kūṣmāṇḍa*) see *kūṣmāṇḍa* :
- wax gourd (*kūṣmāṇḍa*) *Benincasa hispida*, (Thunb.) Cogn. See [AVS](#): 2, 1127; cf. [AVS](#): 1, 261 :
- wax gourd (*puṣpaphala*) see *kūṣmāṇḍa* :
- weaver’s beam tree (*mokṣaka*) see [weaver’s beam tree](#) (*muṣkaka*) : [51](#)
- weaver’s beam tree (*muṣkaka*) *Schrebera swietenoides*, Roxb. See [AVS](#): 5, 88, Lord, [NK](#): 1, #2246, [GVDB](#): 242–243 : [50](#)
- weaver’s beam tree (*pāṭalī*) usually

- a synonym for [crimson trumpet-flower tree](#) (*pāṭalā*), but Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 242–243) argue that it is [weaver's beam tree](#) (*mokṣaka*) because some authors distinguish two colours (unlike *pāṭalā*):
- weaver's beam tree (*viśalyā*) Schrebera swietenoides Roxb. ← *kuberākṣī*. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 371) notes that this name is a synonym for many other plants, including *lāṅgālī*, *indravārūṇi*, *guḍūcī* etc. Ḍalhaṇa identified it with *pāṭalā*, *kāṣṭhapāṭalā*, and *agniśikhā* tree, all of which may be called *śvetamokṣaka* or *kuberākṣī*:
- web-milk (*jālakṣīri*) unknown; translation based on etymology:
- weevil wort (*tālamūlikā*) [GVDB](#): 178–179: [51](#)
- weevil wort (*tālapatrī*) → *tālamūlikā*, [weevil wort](#), q.v. [GVDB](#): 178:
- wheat (*godhūma*) Triticum vulgare, L. See [HK](#): 744:
- white calotropis (*alarka*) Calotropis procera, (Ait.) R. Br. See [NK](#): 1, #428, [Chopra](#): 46b, [Chopra IDG](#): 305–308:
- white clitoria (*sitāX*) Possibly → [white clitoria](#)? Clitoria ternatea, L. See [AVS](#): 2, 129, [NK](#): 1, #621:
- white clitoria (*śvetā*) Clitoria ternatea, L. See [AVS](#): 2, 129, [NK](#): 1, #621. [GVDB](#): 416–417 notes that there are two types, *kṣudrā* (white, according to Ḍalhaṇa) and *mahā* (blue, according to Ḍalhaṇa). Sometimes given as a synonym for [winged-stem canscora](#), but sometimes as a contrasting plant: [51](#)
- white cutch tree (*somavalka*) Acacia polyacantha, Willd. See [AVS](#): 1, 30, [IGP](#) 7, [GJM1](#): 602, [AVS](#): 2, 935; *pace* [NK](#): 1, #1038:
- white dammer tree (*sarja*) Vateria indica, L. See [NK](#): 1, #2571, [AVS](#): 5, 349 f, [AVS](#): 1, 292 f, [Chopra](#): 253a. Singh and Chuneekar ([GVDB](#): 424) discussed whether this term might be broadened to any resinous tree and decided against: [51](#)
- white dammer tree (*sarjja*) see [white dammer tree](#) (*sarja*):
- white lotus (*puṇḍarīka*) see padma, 252:
- white sandalwood (*bhadraśriya*) Santalum album Linn. See [white sandalwood](#) (*bhadraśrī*):
- white sandalwood (*bhadraśrī*) Santalum album Linn. see [sandalwood](#) (*candana*)

- GVDB: 152, 282 and
Carakasamhitā ci.4.102
 (Ca 1941: 434) where it is
 contrasted with
lohitacandana : 51
- white siris (*jalavetasa*) Ḍalhaṇa
 (5.8.105 (Su 1938: 592))
 thought that this was
 vañjula, but he noted that
 Jejjāta thought it was
kambukā, an unidentified
 plant he interpreted as
kiṇihī. AVS: 3, 172–174
 identify *jalavetasa* as
Homonoia riparia Lour.,
 willow-leaved water croton,
 and include a survey of the
 confusions about this plant
 in various texts; they make
 their judgment about *H.*
riparia on the basis of its
 medical effects. See śirīṣa :
- white siris (?) (*kapītana*) Singh and
 Chuneekar (GVDB: 72–73)
 note that this stands for at
 least two plants, milky and
 non-milky. For the latter
 type, they propose *Albizia*
procera (Roxb.) Benth.,
Thespesia (hibiscus-like,
 but not endemic to S. Asia)
 or *Spondias* (cashew). Six
 different identifications are
 made by Monier-Williams,
 Leumann, Cappeller, et al.
 (MW: 251), without
 authority :
- white siris (*kaṭabhī*) *Albizia procera*
 (Roxb.) Benth. or A.
lebbeck (Linn.) Benth.
 GVDB: 63–64,
 AVS: 1, 81–84. See śirīṣa : 44
- white siris (*kiṇihī*) *Albizia procera*
 (Roxb.) Benth., GVDB: 98,
 which also discusses past
 confusions; NK: 1, #93. See
 śirīṣa :
- white teak (*kārśmarī*) see *kāśmarī* :
 white teak (*kāśmarya*) see *kāśmarī* :
 white teak (*kāśmaryā*) see *kāśmarī* :
 white teak (*kāśmarī*) also *kāśmarya*,
kārśmarī, *madhuparṇī*.
Gmelina arborea, Roxb. See
 GJM1: 543, Trees: 51,
 ADPS: 240, 96–97 :
- white teak (*madhuparṇī*) see
kāśmarī :
- white water-lily (*kumuda*)
Nymphaea alba, Linn.,
 GVDB: 105 :
- white-bark acacia (*ahimara*) see
arimeda :
- white-bark acacia (*ahimaraka*) see
arimeda :
- white-bark acacia (*arimeda*)
Vachellia leucophloea
 (Roxb.) Maslin, Seigler &
 Ebinger. See AVS: 1, 23, 22,
 33 :
- wild asparagus (*bahuputrā*)
Asparagus racemosus,
 Willd. See further wild
asparagus (*śatāvarī*)
 Possibly a syn. for *nandana*.
 The bark of wild asparagus
 is toxic :

- wild asparagus (*śatāvārī*)
 Asparagus racemosus,
 Willd. See [ADPS](#): 441,
[AVS](#): 1, 218, [NK](#): 1, #264,
[IGP](#): 103, [AVS](#): 4, 249 ff,
[Dymock](#): 3, 482 ff: [52](#)
- wild celery (*agnika*) → may be
bhallātaka, *lāṅgalī*, *ajamodā*,
moraṭa, or *agnimantha*,
[GVDB](#): 4. Uncertain A plant
 often cited in
Suśrutasaṃhitā, but rarely in
Carakasaṃhitā ([GVDB](#): 4).
 Ḍalhaṇa glossed it at 5.2.45
 ([Su 1938](#): 566) as *ajamodā*
 but noted that others
 consider it to be *moraṭa*.
 There is considerable
 complexity surrounding the
 identification of
moraṭa / *mūrvā* itself and
 related synonyms
 ([GVDB](#): 314–316): [53](#)
- wild celery (*ajamodā*) *Apium*
graveolens, L. Sometimes
 identified with *agnika* ([wild](#)
[celery](#)), q.v.:
- wild guava (*kumbhī*) *Careya indica*
 Roxb., 106–107:
- wild Himalayan cherry (*padmaka*)
Prunus cerasoides D.Don,
[GVDB](#): 236,
[AVS](#): 4, 353–355. [MW](#): 585 is
 wide of the mark:
- wild mustard (*saurīyaka*) *Cleome*
viscosa, L.? (cf. *Rā.4.144*).
 See [AVS](#): 2, 116, [NK](#): 1,
 #615:
- wild spider flower (*ajagandhā*)
 possibly *Cleome gynandra*
 L. (syn. *Gynandropis*
gynandra L.); possibly also
 Basil (*Ocimum basilicum*
 Linn. or Crested Late
 Summer Mint (*Elsholtzia*
ciliata Willd.) ([GVDB](#): 6).
 But *E. ciliata* is not native to
 South Asia:
- wild spider flower (*tailaparnika*) see
[wild spider flower](#):
- wild spider flower (*tilaparnī*)
Cleome gynandra L.,
 184–185, but see the
 discussion of the other drug
 plants sometimes intended
 by this name: [53](#)
- wild sugar cane (*kāṇḍekṣu*)
Saccharum spontaneum L.,
[GVDB](#): 90:
- wild sugarcane (*kāśa*) *Saccharum*
spontaneum L. 96:
- winged-stem canscora (*giriḥvā*) see
[winged-stem canscora](#)
 (*girikarṇikā*):
- winged-stem canscora (*girikarṇikā*)
 sometimes → *śvetā*, in
 which case possibly *Clitoria*
ternatea, L., see [AVS](#): 2, 129,
[NK](#): 1, #621. 41, 138–139
 argued against the
 identification with *C.*
ternatea L. Since *śvetā* and
giriḥvā are cited as separate
 constituents of one formula
 (e.g., *Suśrutasaṃhitā* 5.5.75
 ([Su 1938](#): 579) they cannot

- be the same plant.
[GVDB](#): 138–139 argued for *Symphorema polyandrum* Wight, which they also assigned to *sinduvāra*. When discussing *śaṅkhapuṣpī*, another possible synonym, Sivarajan and Balachandran ([ADPS](#): 425–427) also suggest *Canscora alata* (Roth) Wall. (syn of *Canscora decussata* Schultes & Schultes f.) and *Convulvulus pluricaulis* Choisy. The former has a more appropriate distribution and is chosen here: [53](#), [54](#)
- winged-stem canscora (*giryāhvā*) see [winged-stem canscora](#) (*girikarṇikā*): [51](#)
- winged-stem canscora (*śaṅkhapuṣpī*) see *girikarṇikā*. 385 note that this plant is identified as *Clitoria ternatea* L. in S. India, but as *Canscora decussata* Schult by the majority of Kavirajas in Bengal:
- Withania* (*aśvagandhā*) *Withania somnifera* (L.) Dunal. See [AVS](#): 5, 409 f, [Dymock](#): 2, 566 f, 150, [GVDB](#): 29, [Chevallard](#): 152:
- wood-apple (*kapittha*) *Limonia acidissima*, L. See [AVS](#): 3, 327, [NK](#): 1, #1021:
- woody turmeric (*kāleyaka*) *Coscinium fenestratum* (Goetgh.) Colebr., 95. See V. K. Gupta, Tuohy, O'Donovan, and Lohani [2015](#): 173–175:
- woody-fruit jujube (*ghoṇṭā*) *Ziziphus xylopyrus* (Retz.) Willd., 149:
- woody-fruit jujube (*gopaghoṇṭā*) see *ghoṇṭā*:
- xxx (*śṛṅgavera*) xxx:
- xxx ruby dock (*śuktā*) xxx Monier Williams states *Rumex Vesicarius*:
- yeast (*kiṇva*) [MW](#): 282, [EWA](#): 1, 350:
- yellow-berried nightshade (*kaṇṭakārīkā*) see *kaṇṭakārī*:
- yellow-berried nightshade (*kaṇṭakārī*) *Solanum virginianum* L. (syn. *Solanum surattense* Burm. f. and *Solanum xanthocarpum*, Schrad. & Wendl.) [GVDB](#): 68–69. See also [IHR](#): 430. A component of [lesser five roots](#):
- yellow-berried nightshade (*kṣudrā*) see *kaṇṭakārī*, [ADPS](#): 100, [NK](#): 1, #2329, [AVS](#): 5, 164:

Fauna

ant (*pipīlika*) [MW](#): 627 :

arala rat (*arala-animal*) a hapax
legomenon in Sanskrit,
probably a Dravidian loan
word or cognate from forms
like Pengo, Maṇḍa, Kuwi
etc., *orli*, *urli*, etc.,

[DED₂](#): #994 :

arrow-coloured (*śaravarṇa*)
unknown frog, name from
etymology :

aṭakī (*aṭakī*) unknown :

bad-marked rat (*kuliṅga*)
etymologically, “having
bad-marks” [MW](#): 286, but
unidentifiable :